# 2025-2026 COMPREHENSIVE EDUCATIONAL PLAN (CEP)

**DBN**
06M008

**SCHOOL NAME**
P.S. 008 Luis Belliard

**PRINCIPAL**
Washington Hernandez

# Comprehensive Educational Plan Outline

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# Section 1: Overview of Comprehensive Education Planning

## Overview of Comprehensive Education Planning

Comprehensive Education Planning (CEP) is a structured, data-driven process that guides schools in assessing their needs, identifying areas for growth, setting strategic goals and implementing targeted actions to improve student outcomes. Collaboratively developed by the School Leadership Team (SLT) in accordance with the requirements of Chancellor's Regulation A-655, the CEP meets New York State Education Department (NYSED) requirements under the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) and aligns with NYC Public Schools' (NYCPS) system-wide priorities. By engaging all stakeholders—school leaders, teachers, families, students and community members—schools can create a data-informed, equity-focused roadmap for student success and continuous improvement.

Schools should focus their CEP on the five system-wide priorities below, connecting their planning to the data discussions and conversations with stakeholders held as part of the school's needs assessment:

- Priority 1: All students learn to read well
- Priority 2: All students are physically and emotionally safe
- Priority 3: All students have a high-quality academic experience
- Priority 4: All students graduate college and career ready and have a strong plan and pathway to economic security
- Priority 5: All districts and schools are more inclusive and responsive for parents and families, including having more families choose NYC Public Schools

**The Education Planning Process**

The CEP follows an equity-driven, continuous improvement cycle, rooted in the system-wide priorities. This begins with a comprehensive needs assessment of the school's most current data to identify priority needs and root causes. Next, the SLT establishes **s**pecific, **m**easurable, **a**ttainable, **r**elevant, and **t**imely—SMART goal(s) aligned to each priority and determines targets to measure progress toward meeting the annual goals.

The SLT and instructional leaders define key evidence-based key strategies, professional learning activities and parent, family and community empowerment efforts. They monitor the implementation of those strategies and activities and track progress through measurable targets. Then, the SLT aligns the school-based budget with human and instructional resources to support action plans.

As schools set goals, develop key strategies, and plan action steps, they provide opportunities for all children to meet NYSED's proficient and advanced levels of student academic achievement. These include evidence based instructional strategies that address the educational needs of historically underserved populations and tackle structural inequities. Schools indicate how the plan addresses the needs of Multilingual/English Language Learners (ML/ELL) through development of the school's Language Allocation Policy (LAP) & Title III Application (if applicable) and the Language Translation and Interpretation (LTI) Plan, that are required as part of the CEP. Schools also address the needs of Students with Disabilities (SWD) through the High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities section of the plan. SLTs also develop a plan to improve attendance and reduce chronic absenteeism.

# Guidance on Conducting a Comprehensive Needs Assessment

**Directions:** Conduct a comprehensive needs assessment for each Priority. The information below provides guidance for reviewing and analyzing student and school performance trends to uncover root causes for low student achievement.

**1. Review Multiple Data Sources:** Use the most current and available information including, but not limited to, the following sources of formative and summative data, as applicable:

- Qualitative and quantitative data, including enrollment and class size trends
- 2024-25 ESSA Accountability Data
- Instructional Leadership Framework (ILF), Supportive Environment Framework (SEF) Inventories, and NYC School Survey results
- Quality Review Reports, NYSED and NYCPS CSI or A/TSI Support Visits, Receivership Quarterly Reports, and Diagnostic Tool for School and District Effectiveness Framework (DTSDE)
- NYC School Quality Guide, Insight, New Visions, NWEA MAP and/or other formative assessment data, IEP Review Survey Data, Progress on IEP Goals Data, Program (SESIS-STARS Linkage) Reports, Mandated (Related) Services Reports, and NYCPS Tools for Understanding Your Data for student subgroup information

**2. Analyze Data Trend(s) to Identify Areas of Strength and Need:** Identify data trends by grade, cohort, and content area(s) to surface gaps and inequities. Compare data sets to identify instructional and school practices that are impacting student performance. Guiding questions to consider:

- What does the data reveal about improving and declining student performance trends within grades, cohorts, and student subgroups?
- What inequities are evident between highest and lowest performing student subgroups? Which subgroup(s) scored at Level 1 based on NYSED ESSA accountability indicators?
- What does the data suggest regarding the effectiveness (or ineffectiveness) of current school programs, practices, and/or strategies/initiatives? What areas may need to be strengthened?
- Are there any differences in student performance between program delivery models for ML/ELL and SWD? (e.g., for special education: special class, ICT, SETSS, related services only; for ML/ELL: Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) vs. Dual Language, etc.)
- How does delivery of instruction factor into data trends? What are the implications for teacher quality and professional learning?
- What inequities in special education referral and school disciplinary practices (e.g. suspensions, removals) are evident between student subgroups with IEPs?

**3. Identify Root Cause(s):** After analyzing the data, engage in a process for uncovering root causes or contributing factors for low student and school performance. Develop theories or hypotheses to explain

why these needs exist and why your school is getting its current outcomes. Root causes could be related to gaps and inequities in areas such as curriculum & instruction, school systems & structures, student support services, school climate & safety, and family & community engagement. Focus on the causes, rather than the symptoms. Use the 5 Whys Method or other methods for identifying root causes. Consider the questions below:

- What theories or hypotheses explain the current student and school outcomes?
- Are there root causes specific to certain subgroups, grades, cohorts, or content area(s)?

Additional resources and supports are available below.

- Use this CEP Needs Assessment Worksheet to help your SLT and stakeholders identify appropriate data sources, data trends, root causes and priority needs.
- For guidance and best practices on engaging stakeholders in a comprehensive needs assessment and root cause analysis, see this deck.
- A current list of all CEP/Title I resources can be found on the iPlan Portal Public Resources Page.

# Section 2: School Information

## School Information

**School Name:**

The Luis Belliard School

**District Borough Number (DBN):**

06M008

**Grades Served:**

3K - 5

**School Address:**

465 West 167th Street New York, NY 10032

**Phone Number:**

212-928-4157

**Fax:**

212-928-4072

**School Contact Person:**

Washington Hernandez

**School Contact Person Email Address:**

whernan@schools.nyc.gov

**Principal:**

Washington Hernandez

**United Federation of Teachers (UFT) Chapter Leader:**

Robert McDougall

**Parents' Association President:**

Cinthia Garcia

**SLT Chairperson:**

Eleni Filippatos

**Title I Parent Advisory Council Chairperson (PAC):**

Yari Salvador

**Student Representative(s) Middle /High School:**

**Student Representative(s) Middle /High School:**

**Community Based Organization (CBO) Representative:**

Arnery Reyes

**School-Based Students in Temporary Housing (STH) Liaison:**

Ada Suriel

# District Information

**Geographic District:**

CSD 6

**Superintendent:**

Renzo Martinez

**Superintendent’s Office Address:**

4360-78 Broadway 4th Floor New York, NY 10033

**Superintendent’s Email Address:**

rmartin8@schools.nyc.gov

**Phone Number:**

212-928-4157

**Fax:**

212-928-4072

# Section 3: CEP SLT/Stakeholder Signature Page

## School Leadership Team (SLT) Signature Page

All School Leadership Team (SLT) members are expected to sign this page to confirm their participation in the development of this Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP) and that they have been consulted regarding the alignment of the school-based budget to support this school's educational program, which includes annual goals and action plans, Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS), the Parent and Family Engagement Policy (PFEP) and the School-Parent Compact (SPC). The SLT must include an equal number of parents and staff and have a minimum of 10 and a maximum of 17 members, in accordance with Chancellor's Regulation A-655. The SLT also serves as the Core Community Engagement Team (CET) for Receivership Schools. Additional information and resources are available on the School Leadership Team Resources page. Under the Federal Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), NYS Education Law and Commissioner's Regulations, stakeholder participation in the development of the CEP must include multiple constituencies who represent the school community. Note: Stakeholders participating in the development of the CEP who are not listed on the SLT page sign the section below entitled Additional Stakeholder Participation on CEP Development.

**Directions:** List the names of each SLT member in the first column on the chart below.

- Specify the position and constituent group represented, e.g., parent-PTA, staff-UFT, student. Note: Two student minimum required for high schools; SED requires Middle Schools identified for the CSI/ATSI/TSI support model to have student representation.
- Community Based Organization (CBO), and any position held by the team member. Core mandatory SLT members are indicated by an asterisk*. Note: The Core SLT members also serve as the CET for Receivership schools.
- SLT members should review this document and sign in the Signature If an SLT member does not wish to sign this plan, the member must check the box under the column "Opt Out of Signing, if applicable" and may provide the principal with a written explanation in lieu of a signature, which must be maintained on file at the school and uploaded in iPlan with the original SLT signature page. Note: Signature of SLT member indicates participation in the development of the CEP, not approval.
- The original signed copy, along with any written/electronic communications pertaining to this page, is to remain on file in the principal's office and be made available upon written request.
- Schools may modify their SLT bylaws as needed to address additional school and/or ESSA requirements for stakeholder engagement.

| | | |
|---|---|---|

| SLT Member Name | Position and Constituent Group Represented | Signature |
|---|---|---|
| Washington Hernandez | Principal | |
| Robert McDougall | UFT Chapter Leader | |
| Lynette Jackson | Parent Association President | |
| Ana Leon | SLT Co-Chairperson/Teacher | |
| David Alexander | SLT Co-Chairperson/Teacher | |
| Latifa Parker-Wade | Teacher | |
| Sheila Caro | Teacher | |
| Joseline Hidalgo | Parent | |
| Melissa Cooper | Parent | |
| Mairoby Pichardo | Parent | |
| Eliana Valera | Parent | |
| Arnery Reyes | CBO Director | |
| Niasha Wilson | Parent | |
| | | |

# Additional Stakeholder Signature Page

**Directions:** Stakeholders participating in the development of the CEP who are not listed on the SLT page may sign below. Additional stakeholders may include, but not be limited to, school and district leaders, school staff, parents/families/guardians, students, community organizations, additional Core Community Engagement Team (CET) members (if applicable), members of the School Implementation Team (SIT), and/or school-based staff development committee that serves as the Instructional Leadership Team (ILT) tasked to improve instructional practice across the school. Go to NYSED's guidance on Assembling Your Team to learn more.

- List the names of additional stakeholders in the first column on the chart below.
- Specify the individual's position and constituent group represented.
- Stakeholders should review this document and sign in the Signature column. If the stakeholder does not wish to sign this plan, the member must check the box under the column "Opt Out of Signing, if applicable" and may provide the principal with a written explanation in lieu of a signature, which must be maintained on file at the school and uploaded in iPlan with the original SLT signature page. Note: Signature of the additional stakeholders indicates participation in the development of the CEP, not approval.
- The original signed copy, along with any written/electronic communications pertaining to this page, is to remain on file in the principal's office and be made available upon written request.

| Name | Position and Constituent Group Represented | Signature |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

# Section 4: School Summary

## Accountability Status

Accountability Status: **LSI**

# School Summary

**Directions:** Complete this CEP Summary to serve as the "at-a-glance" narrative that provides contextual information about your school's unique characteristics. This summary and the entire Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP) should be shared with your school community. Please note that this summary and the CEP will be made available to the public through the iPlan Portal, an online space where school stakeholders can go to collaborate in the development of the school's education plans.

**Provide your school's mission statement:**

We will afford all children the opportunity to be responsible, creative, well-adjusted individuals by providing rigorous hands-on instruction, character education, and comprehensive support services. Through shared decision-making, collaborative planning, differentiation, and small group instruction, we will promote a strong foundation of knowledge, skills, and experiences in order to raise academic achievement and develop students who think critically and solve real-world problems.

**Develop a narrative summary that includes contextual information about your school's community and its unique/important characteristics and partnerships:**

Include demographic information about your school's student population.

P.S. 8 The Luis Belliard School is a community school in Washington Heights, Manhattan. We serve approximately 365 students in grades 3K through 5. 97% of our students are Hispanic/Latinx and 44% are English language learners (ELL). To meet the needs of our culturally and linguistically diverse students, particularly those learning English as a new language (ENL), we are proud to offer a variety of instructional programs. P.S. 8 has a Spanish dual language program in grades K-5 for emergent bilinguals. In addition, we offer sheltered instruction in Integrated ENL classrooms as well as push-in/pull-out Stand-alone ENL services.

In addition to serving our English learners, P.S. 8 offers multiple services for students with disabilities, who make up 24% of our population. These services include Integrated Co-Teaching programs, self-contained bridge special education classes, and related services (monolingual and bilingual speech therapy, occupational therapy, adaptive physical education, and counseling).

In partnership with our community based organization, Children's Aid, we are fortunate to provide many other supports to our students and their families. Our student community's Economic Needs Index is 91%, indicating high levels of poverty, temporary housing, and public assistance. To help meet the needs of these students and families, and through our partnership with Children's Aid, we provide access to medical and dental care at our clinic, extended learning time and extracurricular programming, early childhood programming, family workshops, and more.

P.S. 8 is characterized by students, families, and staff as a family. We are a tightly-knit community who welcome and value the diverse cultures, experiences, and perspectives each individual brings.

**Briefly summarize the key initiatives your school will implement this school year.**

Classroom Sizes: To reflect the laws, PS 08 will introduce 60% smaller classroom sizes capped at 20 students for the 2025-2026 school year.

Curricular Shifts:
In 2025-2026, PS 8 will enter year 3 the new curricula in both English Language Arts and Mathematics. In ELA, we will continue to implement Expeditionary Learning Education (EL Education), which is a rigorous structured literacy program committed to knowledge-building, character development, and high-quality student work. In Math, we will continue to implement Illustrative Mathematics, another rigorous program aligned to coherence of standards and the mathematical practices. In year 3, teachers will have access to professional development, furthering their ability to implement curricular instruction. Teaching staff will utilize the information to support students to develop conceptual understanding, mathematical vocabulary, fluency, and critical thinking and problem-solving skills. Through these curricular shifts in ELA and Math, we hope to boost student achievement and better prepare PS 8 students for their futures as competitive 21st century global citizens.

We will continue to utilize S.P.I.R.E to address the need for targeted reading intervention, out of classroom teachers will continue to provide instruction of foundational skills through the S.P.I.R.E program. Our SETTS teacher, ENL out of classroom teachers, and instructional coaches will provide this intervention to specific at-risk students who demonstrate needs specific to phonemic awareness and phonics skills. Acadience and iReady data will be used to create intervention groups.

PS 8 is committed to integrating STEM instruction across the curriculum and providing students with opportunities to develop crucial knowledge and skills that will prepare them to enter our evolving society. All classroom teachers will continue to implement 1-2 projects per year that integrate STEM concepts with other subject areas. Teachers can utilize our newly renovated STEM Inquiry Lab, where robotics kits, Legos, engineering materials, hydroponic gardens, and a 3-D printer are available. In addition, we will continue to provide STEM enrichment through our after school LEGO Robotics club for 60 students in 3rd, 4th, and 5th grade. Those students will further develop their ability to code and engage in the engineering design process in a fun and stimulating way.

**What are the primary digital and/or print curricula/programs used for ELA and Math:**

Indicate the content area, grade band and any adaptations made.

| Content Area (Indicate ELA and Math Only) | Grade Band | Digital and/or Print Curricula/Program | Adaptations |
|---|---|---|---|
| ELA | K-5 | Expeditionary Learning (EL) | For dual language programs, Spanish texts are supplemented |
| ELA | K-3 | Fundations | Utilize decodable texts to align with foundational skills scope and sequence for students to practice independently and apply phonics skills |
| Math | K-5 | Illustrative Math | CGI and Number Talk routines are supplemented to support numeracy |
| ELA | K-2 | Heggerty Phonemic Awareness | |

# Section 5: Priority 1 – All students learn to read well

## Priority 1 Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| 2025 NYS ELA Data 70% below proficiency 43% Level 1 (Far below benchmark) 27% Level 2 (below benchmark) 30% at or above benchmark | Students lack foundational reading skills; the current curriculum relies heavily on whole group instruction and students benefit from small group instruction which is not reflected in the current curriculum or schoolwide instructional practice. | Strengthen Tier 1 core instruction for all students by adapting the curriculum for more guided small group and independent practice/application. Provide professional learning for teachers to adapt instructional practices. |
| | | |
| | | |

# Priority 1

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing school data trends, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal for this Priority informed by the identified priority needs and the relevant systemwide focus areas for literacy outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Systemwide Focus Areas for Literacy**

- Implement the strategies outlined in NYC Reads, including foundational phonics curriculum for grades K-2
- Implement dyslexia screening, professional learning, and program pilots (as applicable)
- Support literacy development through the integration of culturally responsive-sustaining texts and content

# Priority 1 SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| All Students | 70% | By June, 2026, literacy for All Students will improve, as measured by a 10% Decrease, from 70% to 60%, of percentage of students scoring at Levels 1 & 2 on the NYS ELA exam results. |

# Priority 1 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

Acadience Reading

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

percentage of students far below benchmark

**Baseline:**

44%

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

June 2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

44%

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

41%

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

39%

# Priority 1 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 1 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 1 Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

Implement the following schoolwide systems to adapt the core curriculum:
- Decodable texts in all classrooms to be used for the application of skills explicitly taught in the foundational block
- Adapt the EL lessons to spend less time on teacher-centered instruction and allow more time for student inquiry, engagement, and hands-on, direct application of skills and knowledge
- Continue to dedicate a block of time for targeted small-group instruction and center activities

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Students lack foundational reading skills; the current curriculum relies heavily on whole group instruction and students benefit from small group instruction which is not reflected in the current curriculum or schoolwide instructional practice.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| Distribute grade-appropriate decodable texts to all classrooms |
| Provide professional learning targeted towards our goals |
| Arrange for intervisitation to align teacher practice |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

We will monitor progress using our Acadience and iReady data, as well as unit assessments from Fundations. Since the focus is on foundational skills, we will closely monitor the progress of K-2 students in Fundations and provide tiered interventions to ensure they do not fall too far behind in those skills.

# Priority 1 Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/02/2025 | 12/31/2025 | Host workshops for families on strategies to support reading development at home | Partner with CBO and/or outside agencies such as Elevate |
| 05/01/2026 | 05/31/2026 | During open school night in May, teachers will host sessions on games and other fun at-home reading activities | Utilize coaching partners such as Teaching Matters for support and resources |

# Priority 1 Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

### Human Resources

We hired an additional cluster teacher who will provide coverages for teachers to engage in common planning as well as in small group tier 3 tintervention

### Instructional Resources

We purchased i_Ready, IXL, Aprendo Leyendo and

### Schedule Adjustments

Teachers will now have one common planning per week to look anaylize student work and use data to adjust their instruction.

### Other Resources Needed

# Section 5: Priority 2 – All students are physically and emotionally safe

## Priority 2 Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| OORS Data: Incidents are most reported during lunchtime (12 pm - 1 pm). There were16 incidents from September to Jun 3, 2025 | Several classes share small recess spaces with lack of structured play. | Enhance the sense of structure and intentional activities, such as clubs or mentorships, with upper and lower grades early in the school year. Providing additional training for those who supervise during these times. |
| | | |
| | | |

# Priority 2

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing school data trends, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal for this Priority informed by the identified priority needs and the relevant systemwide focus areas **for physical and emotional safety** outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Systemwide Focus Areas for Physical and Emotional Safety**

- Develop safety infrastructure and systems, including staff training, collaboration with external partners, and implementation of safety and security best practices
- Expand social emotional and mental health supports via restorative justice, Project Pivot, screeners, and other district or school-based initiatives (as applicable)
- Expand implementation of physical and mental wellness supports, including Physical and Health Education that meets NYSED requirements and related initiatives
- Improve supports and outcomes for socially vulnerable student populations (Students in Temporary Housing, Students in Foster Care)

# Priority 2 SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| All Students | 16 | By June, 2026, physical and mental wellness for All Students will improve, as measured by a 4 Decrease, in number of incidents reported during lunch periods from 16 to 12, per the Online Occurrence Reporting System (OORS) reports. |

# Priority 2 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

Online Occurrence Reporting System (OORS) reports

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

number of incidents reported during lunch periods

**Baseline:**

16

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

June 2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

4

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

8

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

12

# Priority 2 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

OORS Reporting System

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Incidents During Lunch Time

**Baseline:**

16

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

12/23/25

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

4

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

8

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

12

# Priority 2 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 2 Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

Increase structured play during recess by continuing to partner with external organizations. Train school aides and paraprofessionals to maintain structures during recess periods.

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Several classes share small recess spaces with lack of structured play.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| Create a plan and schedule with Sports and Health organization for structured play during recess |
| Hold training for school aides and paraprofessionals |
| |
| |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

School Safety Committee will meet monthly to review OORS data and to monitor progress towards the goal.

# Priority 2 Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/02/2025 | 12/31/2025 | Inform families of our efforts, structures, and goals during the Safety Meeting for the community at large | NYPD |
| 01/01/2026 | 06/26/2026 | Invite families to participate in school field day to highlight the ways students can engage in safe and productive play, including opportunities for conflict-resolution skills | High Bridge Park |

# Priority 2 Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

### Human Resources

Hire Sports and Health partners, hold training for current staff (school aides and paraprofessionals). Hired a Guidance Counselor to support towards the SEL goals.

### Instructional Resources

SEL Curriculum

### Schedule Adjustments

Brain Power organization will teach teachers on how to schedule "Brain Breaks" for students throughout the day.

### Other Resources Needed

N/A

# Section 5: Priority 3 – All students have a high-quality academic experience

## Priority 3 Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| According to Acadience math data from June 2025, 38% of all students in K-5 are far below benchmark for their grade level. In Spring 2025, 31% of all students in grades 3-5 scored Level 1 on the Math state exam, while 34% were proficient (levels 3 and 4). | Students struggle with reading comprehension and critical thinking required to understand and solve complex math problems. | Teachers need to professional development to better engage students in critical thinking processes and using Socratic questioning techniques to push students. |
| When looking at subgroups, 41.4% of general education students scored proficient in Mathematics on the state exam in 2025, compared to 3.4% of students with disabilities who scored proficient. Furthermore, 69% | Students struggle with reading comprehension and critical thinking | Teachers need to professional development to better engage students in critical thinking processes |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| students with disabilities scored at Level 1 in Math on the 2024 state exam. | required to understand and solve complex math problems | and using Socratic questioning techniques to push students. |
| | | |

# Priority 3

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing school data trends, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal for this Priority informed by the identified priority needs and the relevant systemwide focus areas **for high-quality academics** outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Systemwide Focus Areas for High Quality Academics**

- Strengthen mathematics instruction, including via screener administration and Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS)
- Embed culturally responsive-sustaining texts and content (e.g., Hidden Voices, Black Studies Curriculum, etc.) in history, literature, and arts curricula to deepen civic engagement, enhance understanding of diverse cultures and provide relevant and affirming interventions in literacy development
- Ensure multilingual language learners (MLLs) are served and progressing in appropriate settings; expand bilingual programming and professional learning for educators who support MLLs
- Ensure students with disabilities are served and progressing in the least restrictive and most appropriate settings; improve delivery of mandated services and expand specialized programs
- Ensure that Students in Temporary Housing (STH) and Students in Foster Care access opportunities to receive tutoring and are purposefully engaged in new programs developed in the school
- Elevate health and physical education and activities for a reimagined and engaged student academic experience promoting social, emotional, and physical wellness and wellbeing
- Ensure teachers attend Physical Education and Health Education professional learning in order to provide quality instruction to be able to support and address the physical, mental, social, and emotional needs of the whole child in a safe and supportive learning environment
- Strengthen Early Childhood Education program utilization, quality, and ability to serve all students
- Elevate arts and civics for a reimagined and more engaged student academic experience
- Increase school staff diversity and retention
- Create new programs/schools in response to community need; expand high quality seats

# Priority 3 SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| All Students | 31% | P.S. 8 will address Priority 3: All students have a high-quality academic experience with the following SMART Goal: By June, 2026, the percentage of students scoring at Level 1 will Decrease by 10 from 31% to 21%, for All Students, as measured by NYS Math Exam results . |

# Priority 3 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

Acadience Math Benchmark Assessment

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Far below benchmark

**Baseline:**

21%

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

June 2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

31%

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

25%

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

21%

# Priority 3 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 3 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 3 Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

Assess students to identify Tier 3 intervention groups.
Implement research-based strategies, such as pre-teaching.
Utilize the core curricular resources to provide targeted Tier 3 intervention.
Focus on individual growth for each student: Identify the specific Level 1 students and create individual goals and monitor progress towards their goals monthly.

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Students struggle with reading comprehension and critical thinking required to understand and solve complex math problems.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| Assess students using Acadience benchmark |
| Form Tier 3 intervention groups |
| Monitor progress monthly to target small group and individual instruction (Tier 3) |
| |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

To monitor the implementation of key strategies and action steps outlined above, we will utilize the following structures and data sources:

Monitoring Structures:
Instructional Leadership Team (ILT): Meets bi-weekly to review instructional practices, analyze student work, and monitor progress toward academic goals.

School Leadership Team (SLT): Meets monthly to assess implementation fidelity, review data trends, and adjust strategies as needed.

Grade-Level Data Inquiry Teams: Convene monthly to analyze formative assessment data, identify instructional gaps, and plan targeted interventions.

Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS): Tracks student progress across academic and behavioral domains, ensuring timely support for students at risk.

Data and Evidence Collection:
Formative Assessments: i-Ready and teacher-created assessments in ELA and Math.
Summative Assessments: NYS ELA and Math exams, and periodic benchmark assessments.
Attendance and Behavior Data: Used to assess student engagement and identify patterns impacting learning.

Student Work Samples and Portfolios: Reviewed during ILT and grade-level meetings.
Progress Monitoring Tools: MTSS documentation, intervention logs, and anecdotal records.
Family Engagement Metrics: Participation rates in workshops, surveys, and parent-teacher conferences.

Instructional Impact: Measured through classroom walkthroughs, lesson plan reviews, and teacher feedback aligned to the Danielson Framework.
Student Learning: Evaluated through growth in assessment scores, quality of student work, and progress toward IEP goals.
Achievement Outcomes: Tracked via subgroup performance analysis, proficiency rates, and progress toward SMART goals.

# Priority 3 Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/02/2025 | 06/30/2026 | Create sessions for families during family conferences to educate them about the importance of attendance in after school or vacation intervention academies. Increase outreach to families to communicate importance and ensure attendance. | Partner with CBO Children's Aid to ensure attendance in programs of students already in after school. |
| | | | |

# Priority 3 Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

**Human Resources**

Utilize per session funding for teachers to staff small group intervention programs after schools

**Instructional Resources**

Core curriculum

**Schedule Adjustments**

Schedule intervention programs after school and during vacations

**Other Resources Needed**

N/A

# Section 5: Priority 4 – All students graduate college and career ready and have a strong plan and pathway to economic security

## Priority 4 Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| 10% RISE accounts activated | Parents may not be aware of the accounts or know how to activate it. | Increase awareness, increase access and host events to support account activation. |
| | | |
| | | |

# Priority 4

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing school data trends, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal for this Priority informed by the identified priority needs and the relevant systemwide focus areas for **college and career readiness** outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Systemwide Focus Areas for College and Career Readiness**

- Expand career pathways and work-based learning, opportunities for early college credit and industry credentials, and college/career advising and awareness, including via the Career Readiness Modern Youth Apprenticeship and FutureReadyNYC (as applicable)
- Schools serving students in early childhood, elementary, and middle school settings should consider how they expose students to and prepare them for advanced (Regents-level) coursework, Specialized High School Admission Test (SHSAT) preparation, college awareness, career studies, etc.
- Integrate historical and contemporary contributions of culturally diverse professionals, scholars, and entrepreneurs into career readiness programs, ensuring students see diverse pathways to success
- Incorporate lessons on wealth-building strategies, cooperative economics, and financial independence to equip students with tools for long-term economic security
- Ensure the implementation of specialized support programs tailored for Students in Temporary Housing and/or Foster Care, addressing their unique educational needs and challenges

# Priority 4 SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| All Students | 10% | <School Name> will address Priority 4: All students graduate college and career ready and have a strong plan and pathway to economic security with the following SMART Goal: By June, 2026, the Percentage of active NYC RISE college savings accounts for All Students will Increase by 40 from 10% to 50% as measured by NYC RISE Enrollment Reports. |

# Priority 4 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

NYC RISE Enrollment Reports

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Percentage of active NYC RISE college savings accounts

**Baseline:**

10%

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

June 2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

10%

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

25%

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

50%

# Priority 4 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 4 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 4 Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

This strategy aims to significantly increase understanding and knowledge of the benefits and purpose of NYC RISE accounts throughout our school community. Recognizing that a primary barrier to enrollment is often a lack of awareness, this key lever for success will introduce new, targeted communication initiatives and enhance existing information dissemination methods. The goal is to move beyond passive information sharing and actively engage students and families with compelling reasons to activate their NYC RISE accounts. This strategy is new in its comprehensive and proactive approach to awareness-building, moving from incidental mentions to a school-wide campaign that highlights the direct advantages for students' academic and future success.

**Root Cause Addressed:**

The root causes being addressed pertain to the recognition and understanding among parents regarding the essential value of opening a NYC RISE account. This highlights the need to raise significance of the accounts in the minds of parents. This helps ensure they view this as a critical step in securing their child's educational and financial future. By addressing these root causes, efforts aim to foster a strong association between parental involvement and the proactive management of resources that will support long-term academic and personal development outcomes.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| During our annual in person Fall open school nights, we will set up info tables to raise awareness and give parents guidance to set up the NYC RISE accounts. |
| Our school has monthly "Coffee & Tea With the Principal" events where parents can come and interact with our |

| |
|---|
| Children's Aid coordinator and Principal. During these meetings we can spread more awareness to opening NYC RISE accounts as well as hands on help. |
| We will place flyers at the front desk and in the office for parents to grab on the go. |
| We will have our parent coordinator post incremental reminders on the Instagram and Class Dojo accounts for information and links. |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
|---|
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

We will monitor progress by observing direct data from NYC RISE, collecting data from the school survey, and doing indirect surveys throughout the year.

# Priority 4 Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/17/2025 | 09/17/2025 | In-person open school night #1 - we will have info-sessions and staff to help parents set up accounts | Principal, teachers, Parent coordinator |
| 05/07/2026 | 05/07/2026 | In-person open school night #2 - we will have info-sessions and staff to help parents set up accounts - we will have a list of parents who have not enrolled at this time and invite those parents specifically to attned | Principal, teachers, Parent coordinator |

# Priority 4 Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

**Human Resources**

Principal, parent coordinator, teachers.

**Instructional Resources**

Pamphlets/flyers/posters from NYC rise

**Schedule Adjustments**

SBO for in-person open school nights in September and May

**Other Resources Needed**

N/A

# Section 5: Priority 5 – All districts and schools are more inclusive and responsive for parents and families, including having more families choose NYC Public Schools

## Priority 5 Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| Low attendance at school- | Parents are not interested in workshop topics. Some | Survey families to get a sense of their needs and wants. Create ways to draw in parent engagement (raffles, social events, etc.) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| sponsored events | of our ideas of parent engagement may not be suited for our parents' needs. | Expand family engagement to include digital events/activities accessible at different times, etc. Include families in instructional practices and projects to involve parents directly in learning |
| Sometimes communication is lacking between the teachers/school and parents/families | Parent coordinator served role for a brief time before transitioning to secretary role. Position has been vacant | Hire a new PC and support relationship building. Create effective structures for family communication. |
| | | |

# Priority 5

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing the school data, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal for this Priority informed by the identified priority needs and the relevant systemwide focus areas **for parent, family, community and system responsiveness** outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Focus Areas for System Responsiveness to Parents, Families and Communities**

- Engage more deeply with families to understand their needs and plan new, high-quality programs
- Build community trust and bolster engagement, including via improved language access and increased family engagement and participation
- Implement the newly updated NYCPS School Wellness Policy, which provides a framework for all members of the school community, including families and students, to come together and assess and coordinate wellness efforts for their community
- Implement and lead strategies that support community involvement and increase Minority and Women Owned Business Enterprises (MWBE) utilization

# Priority 5 SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| Parents of All Students | 93% | P.S. 8 will address Priority 5: All districts and schools are more inclusive and responsive for Parents of All Students with the following SMART Goal: By June, 2026, the percentage of parents/families attending a school meeting, or parent-teacher conferences (virtually or in-person) will Increase by 6 from 93% to 99% as measured by NYC School Survey Results. |

# Priority 5 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

Parent Coordinator Attendance Logs

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Attendance

**Baseline:**

93

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

9/18/2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

94%

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

96%

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

99%

# Priority 5 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 5 Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Priority 5 Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

Class Dojo has been very effective in some classrooms. We will encourage this as a school-wide system and communication platform to increase engagement and two-way communication with families.
We will plan to host more game nights/movie nights throughout the year to foster a fun, welcoming environment for families and increase attendance at school-sponsored events.

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Parents are not interested in workshop topics. Some of our ideas of parent engagement may not be suited for our parents' needs.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| Train staff on Class Dojo |
| Create a planning committee for family nights |
| Host quarterly family nights |
| |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

Parent Coordinator, Family Worker, and District Attendance teacher will meet every other Wednesday to monitor progress towards this goal.

# Priority 5 Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/02/2025 | 10/01/2025 | Implement a school-wide communication system such as Class Dojo | |
| 09/02/2025 | 06/26/2026 | Ensure all family contact info is up to date. Create text and email groups to ensure regular two-way communication | |

# Priority 5 Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

**Human Resources**

Hired a Parent Coordinator

**Instructional Resources**

Class Dojo Platform

**Schedule Adjustments**

Meetings every other Wednesday

**Other Resources Needed**

N/A

# Section 5: Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism

## Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs |
|---|---|---|
| In 2024-2025, 35% of students were chronically absent. The Year to Date (YTD) attendance was 89%. | Illnesses in young children, appointments, students staying on register even when they are not in NYC/ enrolled at PS 8 | |
| | | |
| | | |

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing the school data, exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop at least one outcome-focused SMART goal aligned to our systemwide focus on improving attendance and **reducing chronic absenteeism**.

**Systemwide Focus Area for Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism:** Develop and implement strengthened practices to improve attendance, combat chronic absenteeism and center equity. Note: For ESSA accountability purposes, NYSED will replace the Chronic Absenteeism indicator with the Attendance indicator, beginning in the 2025-26 school year. Learn more about the new Attendance indicator by reviewing this Fact Sheet.

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| All Students | 89% | By June, 2026, the Year to Date Attendance for All Students will increase by 6, from 89% to 95%, as measured by the New Visions Chronic Absenteeism Reort. |

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

New Visions

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Year to Date Attendance

**Baseline:**

89

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

9/18/2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

89%

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

91%

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

93%

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

New Visions

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

Year to Date Attendance

**Baseline:**

89

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

6/26/2025

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

89

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

1/31/2026

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

6/26/26

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Action Plan

**Directions:** Identify the key strategy and progressive action steps your school will take to address the specific priority needs and root causes identified for this goal(s). More than one strategy can be indicated if multiple and/or differentiated needs for this priority have been identified.

- Key strategies should be key levers for success and may represent something that is new to the school.
- Action steps to operationalize key strategies should focus on new activities or initiatives and/or modifications to current initiatives (e.g., expanded to reach a wider audience or refined for greater impact on students).

Note: Routine activities your school does every year should not be included.

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

School Family Worker and Parent Coordinator will call parents of students whom are absent 2 consecutive days without an excuse.
Monthly "Perfect Attendance " awards.
Incentives like a pizza party for the class with the highest monthly attendance higher than 90%

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Students not coming in to school.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| School Family Worker and Parent Coordinator will call parents of students whom are absent 2 consecutive days without an excuse. |
| Monthly "Perfect Attendance " awards. |
| Incentives like a pizza party for the class with the highest monthly attendance higher than 90% |
| |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

Goal: Increase YTD attendance to 93%, up from 89% last year.

Platform Used: New Visions attendance dashboard for real-time tracking.

Monitoring Team: A dedicated Attendance Team meets weekly (Wednesdays) to:
Review attendance trends and identify students with chronic absenteeism.
Coordinate outreach efforts with families and support staff.
Implement targeted interventions (e.g., home visits, counseling, incentives).

Data Collected:
Daily and YTD attendance rates.
Chronic absenteeism reports.
Intervention logs and follow-up outcomes.

Impact Evaluation:
Attendance data is cross-referenced with academic performance and engagement indicators.
Progress is reported monthly to the School Leadership Team (SLT) & Child Study Team (CST), and used to adjust strategies.

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the strategies/activities that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster and birth parents) and community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan.

| Start Date | End Date | Strategies to Support Family & Community Engagement | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10/01/2025 | 01/31/2026 | Monthly Coffee & Tea with the Principal meetings will include Attendance data and resources for families. | CAS |
| 02/01/2026 | 06/26/2026 | Outreach such as home visits and providing families with outside agencies for attendance support. | CAS |

# Attendance/Chronic Absenteeism Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

### Human Resources

Hired a Parent Coordinator

### Instructional Resources

We now have a STEM and Hydroponics lab that ALL students have access to as a cluster program to increase student engagement and interest in coming to school.

### Schedule Adjustments

Family Worker and Parent Coordinator will share the duties of the plan during their daily schedule.

### Other Resources Needed

Funds for attendance awards and class incentives

# Section 5: High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities

## High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Data Trends, Root Causes and Priority Needs

**Priority Needs and Root Causes**

**Directions: After conducting your comprehensive needs assessment for this Priority use the chart below to:**

- **Summarize the data trends (gaps in student and school performance) for each priority. Use the most current data available and cite the data sources and years.**
- **Identify the root causes (and/or contributing factors, theories, hypotheses) that explain the current student and school outcomes.**
- **Indicate the high leverage priority needs determined by your school that, if resolved, will advance equity and result in measurable, positive impact on student outcomes.**

Guiding Questions:
1. Data Trends: What did you see as you analyzed data trends? Cite data sources and years, including those available from NYCPS and NYSED.
2. Root Causes: What do you believe are the reasons within the school's control that are leading to these outcomes?
3. Priority Needs: What are the most important needs identified after completing your needs assessment?

| 1. Data Trend(s) (Cite Data Source & Year) | 2. Root Cause(s) | 3. Priority Needs (NYCPS Systemwide Needs for all schools noted below.) |
|---|---|---|
| SESIS reports, IEP reviews | Different levels of training on IEP development | IEP Development and Fidelity of Implementation |
| SESIS reports | Need to rework compliance tracking system and supervision | Transition Planning and Compliance |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Referral Rate | Insufficient early intervention supports in the general education classes resulted in an increased referral rate for the 2024-2025 SY | Referral Process and Equity |
| OORS reports | Ensuring consistency with classroom discipline practices | Equity in School Discipline |
| | | |

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities

**Directions:** After conducting a comprehensive needs assessment by analyzing school data trends including IEP Review Surveys; exploring your school vision/values/aspirations, and listening to students to surface priority needs and identify root causes, develop outcome-focused SMART goals for identified priority need(s) and the relevant systemwide focus areas for **High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities** outlined below. Use the SMART Goal builder in iPlan for support in developing your goal.

**Systemwide Focus Areas for High Quality Inclusive and Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities:**

- IEP Development and Implementation
- Transition Planning and Compliance
- Referral Process and Equity
- Equity in School Discipline

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities SMART Goal(s)

| Target Population | Baseline Data | SMART Goal |
|---|---|---|
| Students with Disabilities (SWD) | 93% | By May, 2026, to strengthen the quality and implementation of IEPs for Students with Disabilities (SWD), we will improve we will improve the quality and implementation of IEPs for students with disabilities (SWD) by increasing our IEP compliance rate from 93% to 95%. by a 2% Increase, from 93% to 95%, as measured by SESIS and Power BI. |

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Progress Measures and Targets

**Directions:** It is expected that progress monitoring, based on interim outcome data, occurs at three progress monitoring periods during the school year. Identify what your school would expect to see at the end of each period to know if you are on track to reach the identified goal(s). The progress monitoring targets can be a percentage or a number and should reflect a sufficient improvement in outcomes to meet the goal. Note that all schools are required to enter results in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) on the iPlan Portal.

**Enter a Measurement Tool:**

**Enter a Key Performance Indicator**

**Baseline:**

**Enter the date for the baseline data:**

**Enter Period 1: Beginning of Year (BOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 2: Middle Of Year (MOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

**Enter Period 3: End of Year (EOY) Progress Target:**

Reminder: Actual results will be entered in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT).

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Action Plan

**Key Strategy 1 (Required):**

By October 2025, deliver targeted professional development on best practices and tools for progress monitoring. Establish a consistent schedule of data review meetings with special education staff and service providers to evaluate student progress and inform timely instructional adjustments.

**Root Cause Addressed:**

Inconsistent or ineffective use of progress monitoring tools and data to drive instruction for students with disabilities.

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| Design and deliver targeted professional development sessions focused on effective progress monitoring tools, data interpretation, and instructional adjustments by October 2025. |
| Implement a regular schedule of collaborative data review meetings involving special education staff and service providers to discuss student progress and plan instructional changes. |
| Develop and distribute clear protocols and guidelines for consistent progress monitoring, data collection, and follow-up actions to ensure accountability and standardization. |
| |
| |

**Key Strategy 2 (Optional):**

**Root Cause Addressed:**

**Action Steps:**

Indicate what your school will do specifically to implement each strategy to achieve this annual goal. Include both student-facing activities and professional learning for staff. Be sure to indicate how action steps will be introduced and rolled out.

| Action Steps |
| --- |
| |

**Implementation Monitoring: Indicate your primary structures to progress monitor implementation of key strategies and action steps. Include specific data/evidence you will collect and use to determine progress and impact on instruction, student learning, and achievement.**

**Note: Implementation Progress Checks will be conducted in the Progress Reporting Tool (PRT) in the iPlan Portal for the 2025-26 school year.**

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Family and Community Engagement

**Family and Community Engagement**

**Directions:** Indicate the multi-tiered supports (strategies & activities) that will be implemented to support and engage families (including foster parents, birth parents, and families with limited English proficiency) and plans for community collaboration in the implementation of this action plan, surrounding the four priority needs. Include:

1) a description of the school's supports and processes for students with disabilities;
2) a coherent mechanism is implemented for updating families on their child's progress towards measurable annual and post-secondary transition goals;
3) a procedure to ensure families are involved during decision-making for IEP development and implementation.

| Start Date | End Date | Multi-tiered Supports to Engage Family & Community | Partners/CBOs Leveraged |
|---|---|---|---|
| 09/04/2025 | Enhance family engagement by providing regular progress reports and facilitating meaningful conversations about student goals. | SBST and Outside Agencies | |
| | | | |

# High Quality Inclusive & Accessible Learning for Students with Disabilities Budget and Resources

**Budget and Resources**

**Directions: Indicate available and anticipated resources that will be leveraged to achieve this annual goal and implement this action plan, including human resources, instructional resources (e.g., curricula, programs), schedule adjustments, other. Use N/A if not applicable and/or indicate other resource needs.**

**Schools are encouraged to think critically and strategically when considering resources that can support progress towards CEP goals for students with IEPs. This includes utilizing Title I funding for at-risk speech and/or counseling services, all-staff training in supporting students with autism, sensory materials, summer institute geared at the development of executive functioning skills, and/or inclusion coaching support. Schools may also consider utilizing Title II funds to reduce the ratio of students with IEPs to typically developing peers in ICT classes.**

**Human Resources:**

Special Education Teachers and Assistant Principal

**Instructional Resources**

SPIRE, iReady, IXL, Phonics to Reading, Wilson, Acadience Progress Monitoring

**Schedule Adjustments**

Grade-level team planning (or 6th prep period) embedded into the master schedule (minimum one planning session per week)

**Other Resources Needed**

# Section 6: Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS)

## Academic Support

**NYCPS Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS)** align with NYSED guidelines for providing Academic Intervention Services (AIS) to students who have not yet met state standards or are considered to be at-risk of not meeting state standards. The Multi-tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) framework, organizes **supports** into three tiers:

**Tier 1** provides schoolwide, high-quality programming for all students, including SWDs;

**Tier 2** offers data informed small-group interventions for at-promise students; and

**Tier 3** delivers intensive, individualized support for students with persistent needs.

This facilitates the strategic planning and necessary resource alignment to ensure their school community appropriately and adequately serves all students well, in partnership with students and families.

MTSS identifies the academic support services to be provided and ensures that students receive Response to Intervention (RtI) and Positive Behavioral Interventions and Support (PBIS) strategies as needed. See NYSED's memo to view the criteria for determining AIS services. The Supportive Environment Framework (SEF) offers a wide range of evidence-based Tier 2 and Tier 3 interventions and supports for student social-emotional, behavioral, physical and mental wellness, with particular attention to the unique needs of students in Temporary Housing and/or Foster Care, who may face additional challenges related to school stability, trauma and access to educational resources. A culturally responsive-sustaining approach to intervention embeds culturally relevant texts and historical narratives into literacy and social studies interventions, ensuring students receive the support that reflects their identities and lived experiences, increasing engagement and achievement.

Use the charts below and a Multi-Tiered System of Support (MTSS) to match academic, social/emotional, behavioral and instructional resources with student needs to provide targeted support for all learners, especially at-risk students who experience difficulty meeting state standards, including those living in Temporary Housing and/or residing in Foster Care placements. Indicate specialized materials, technology-based tools and/or extra instruction, including Expanded Learning Time that supplement school-wide systems & supports and/or classroom level supports. Ensure that interventions address the unique social-emotional, behavioral and academic challenges faced by culturally and linguistically diverse students, as well as those impacted by housing instability and child welfare system involvement.

**Directions: Complete the chart and identify Tier 2 or 3 MTSS Academic supports. Any Tier 2/3 interventions should be in addition to the foundational work being done at Tier 1.**

Any Tier 2/3 interventions should be in addition to the foundational work being done at Tier 1.

| Academic Support Indicate Tier 2 or 3 | Criteria for Determining Service | Program Type or Strategy | Service Delivery Model (Small group, one-to-one, tutoring, etc.) | When is Service Provided? (Before, during or after school) | Technology-Based Tool (Indicate Yes or No) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Children's Aid After School Program - Tier 2 | | Expanded Learning Time | Small group | After school (2:20 PM - 5:00 PM) | No |
| Literacy Intervention - Tier 2 and 3 | Student scores below grade level on STAR Reading and/or EL Education assessments | Out of Classroom Intervention | Small group and one-to-one as needed | During school | No |
| Math Intervention - Tier 2 and 3 | Student scores below grade level on STAR Math and/or Illustrative Mathematics assessments | Out of Classroom Intervention | Small group and one-to-one as needed | During school | No |

# Student Social/Emotional Support

**Directions: Complete the chart and identify Tier 2 or 3 MTSS Student Social/Emotional supports. Any Tier 2/3 interventions should be in addition to the foundational work being done at Tier 1.**

| Student Social/Emotional Support Indicate Tier 2 or 3 | Criteria for Determining Service | Program Type or Strategy | Service Delivery Model (Small group, one-to-one, tutoring, etc.) | When is Service Provided? (Before, during or after school) | Technology-Based Tool (Indicate Yes or No) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Social Emotional Intervention - Tier 2 and 3 | Service will be initiated by the referral of the teacher/ staff or parent. The service will be determined by the School's Child Study Team. For example, if a student is not showing growth or progress through Tier 1 after multiple strategies/ skills are taught they will be referred for tier 2 or 3. Reasons for referral can be but are not limited to behavior, grief, isolation, suicidal behaviors, academic struggles, etc. | At-risk Counseling or Intervention | Depending on the needs of the student service can be one on one or small group setting. | Service will be provided during school hours or during the after school program through our CBO. | No |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |

# Family and Community Engagement Around MTSS

**Describe how the school's essential components of MTSS are shared with families.**

Our school prioritizes transparent and inclusive communication with families regarding the essential components of MTSS.
We utilize multiple channels to ensure families are informed and engaged:

Class Dojo: Regular updates and messages are shared to keep families informed about MTSS practices and student support strategies.

Monthly Coffee & Tea with the Principal: These informal gatherings provide opportunities to discuss MTSS initiatives, answer questions, and gather feedback from families.

Backpacked Flyers: Printed materials are sent home with students to explain MTSS components, upcoming events, and available resources.

PA Meetings: MTSS updates and discussions are included in PTA agendas to foster collaboration and shared understanding between staff and families.

These efforts help build a strong partnership with families, ensuring they understand how MTSS supports student success and how they can be involved.

**Describe how families receive updates on the progress of their child(ren) who receive Tier 2 targeted, or Tier 3 intensive interventions.**

Families of students receiving Tier 2 targeted or Tier 3 intensive interventions are kept informed through interim academic progress reports provided by their child's intervention teacher.

These reports include:
Updates on academic performance and growth in targeted areas.
Details of the interventions being implemented, including frequency and focus.
Recommendations for continued support at home and school.
Opportunities for follow-up conversations with staff to review progress and adjust plans as needed.

This consistent communication ensures families are actively involved in their child's learning journey and can collaborate with educators to support ongoing success.

**Describe how families are involved during decision making regarding the progress of students receiving Tier 3 intensive intervention.**

Families play a vital role in the decision-making process for students receiving Tier 3 intensive interventions.

At our School Leadership Team (SLT) meetings, parents are actively engaged in discussions about our school's vision, mission, and goals related to MTSS. These meetings provide a platform for families to:

Review student progress and intervention outcomes.
Collaborate with educators to adjust support plans based on data.
Share insights about their child's needs and strengths.
Help shape school-wide strategies for improving Tier 3 supports.

This inclusive approach ensures that families are not only informed but also empowered to contribute meaningfully to decisions that impact their child's academic and social-emotional growth.

# Students in Temporary Housing (STH) Support

As included in your school's Office of School and Youth Development Consolidated Plan-STH Section and in accordance with the federal McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act and Chancellor's Regulation A-780, schools must identify, serve, and report on students living in temporary housing (STH). All Title I and non-Title I schools receive a Title I allocation for STH students. The Students in Temporary Housing (STH) website provides guidance on STH pupils and how these funds can be used to meet their needs, as well as restrictions. For more information on acceptable uses of the mandated Title I, Part A set-aside to support your STH population, please refer to the Title I STH Funds Toolkit.

**Identify the number of Students in Temporary Housing who are currently attending your school and provide a breakdown of their temporary housing status. Since the number of STH children can change regularly, schools must carefully track this number to determine whether there has been an increase in need.**

Number of students in temporary housing who are:

- Doubled up (with friends or relatives because they cannot find or afford housing):
- Living in a shelter or transitional shelter:
- Living in a hotel/motel:
- Other

*Note: In keeping with established practices regarding personally identifiable information, use the letter "s" to identify a number less than five (5).

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**After a careful analysis of historical demographic, attendance and achievement data for your STH population, what trends do you notice, and how can these trends inform the services and support provided for this population?**

Observed Trends in STH Population
Chronic Absenteeism
Students in temporary housing at PS 8M show elevated rates of chronic absenteeism, which is consistent with citywide patterns. Housing instability often leads to frequent school changes, transportation challenges, and emotional stress, all of which contribute to inconsistent attendance.

Academic Performance Gaps
STH students tend to score lower on state assessments in both ELA and Math compared to their housed peers. This is likely due to disrupted learning environments and limited access to academic support outside of school.

Social-Emotional Needs
The school has implemented mental health and wellness programs, including access to a School-Based Health Center with mental health services. This reflects a recognition of the heightened emotional and psychological needs of students facing housing instability.

Demographic Concentration
PS 8M serves a predominantly Latinx student population and offers a dual-language Spanish program. Many STH students are English Language Learners (ELLs), which adds another layer of academic and social complexity.

**Describe the services you are planning to provide to the STH population. How were those services selected to best meet students' needs? How will you (or did you) utilize the STH Title I Survey to select services aligned to need?**

Students in Temporary Housing (STH) receive supports in a number of different areas. All students, including STH, receive access to free meals (breakfast and lunch; supper if enrolled in Children's Aid after school program), healthcare through the clinic, and academic and/or social emotional interventions when needed. STH also receive packages with any materials they need for school, including backpacks, school uniforms, shoes, jackets, school supplies, and other items they may express need for. In addition, STH receive at-risk counseling to address any transitions, stresses, or trauma they may be suffering from.

# Prioritizing Students in Foster Care

As included in your school's Office of School and Youth Development Consolidated Plan-Child Child Abuse and Neglect Intervention and Prevention School Plan and in accordance with the federal Education Law 3244 – Education of Children in Foster Care (Effective 2018) establishes the rights of students placed, or moved, in foster care to:

- Continue attending school of origin if determined to be in their best interest, or, if not, attend school near foster care placement,
- Immediate enrollment, and
- Transportation, if necessary to attend school of origin

Please respond to the questions below.

**How many students in foster care are currently enrolled at your school? Provide a detailed breakdown of the social-emotional and academic supports available to them.**

N/A

**What targeted supports are in place for students in foster care, including those newly transitioning into the foster care system? How does your school ensure these students receive the necessary interventions to promote stability and success?**

N/A

**After analyzing historical demographic, attendance, and achievement data for students in foster care, what trends have emerged? How can these insights be used to improve the services and support provided to this population?**

N/A

**What specific strategies does your school implement to ensure students in foster care, particularly those in transitional grades, receive targeted Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) support? How do these strategies help address academic and behavioral challenges?**

N/A

# Expanded Learning Time (ELT) Support

The ELT program aligns with Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) and will be offered to all eligible students who are considered at-risk of not meeting state standards. Note: Receivership schools must commit to 200 student contact hours of ELT.

**Describe how your school will utilize ELT to offer opportunities for enrichment and additional learning before, during, after school, on weekends and/or during the summer to actively address the unique learning needs and interests of all types of students, especially those who may benefit from approaches and experiences not offered in the traditional classroom setting.**

P.S. 8 will utilize a variety of Expanded Learning Time (ELT) to provide opportunities for our students. In addition, we plan to offer academic enrichment academies in in Mathematics and English Language Arts in the spring for students in third, fourth, and fifth grade. These after-school academies will be run by our licensed teachers with the support of Children's Aid staff. This approach allows for smaller teacher to student ratios and instruction targeted to the specific needs of the students.

Additionally, a team of teachers at P.S. 8 will launch a LEGO Robotics Club for students in third through fifth grade. These teachers have been trained in the LEGO Spike Prime program and are equipped to engage students in hands-on Integrated STEM learning. The club will also meet during ELT after school.

Finally, P.S. 8 will offer its annual Title III Saturday Academy to meet the needs of our students who are English learners. This program will be run by certified ENL or Bilingual teachers and take place on Saturday mornings. During the Title III Saturday Academy, emergent bilinguals will engage in explicit language instruction as well as content-specific sheltered instruction (Math, ELA, STEM). This approach addressed the unique linguistic needs of our students and provides opportunities to develop academic language, and vocabulary, apply language learning in academic contexts, and engage in interpersonal communication skills.

**Describe how your school will meet the requirement of ensuring that ELT instruction is delivered under the supervision of a teacher who is NYS certified in that content area.**

All position postings for ELT instruction specify the content area license required for teachers interested in applying. Teachers are selected and hired based on their eligibility and NYS certifications. All ELT instruction is delivered under the supervision of teachers certified in the content area of the program.

**Describe how your school will meet the requirement of ensuring the alignment of ELT instruction with core academic subject area instruction offered during the regular school day.**

P.S. 8's ELT instruction will be led by P.S. 8 teachers who teach the core academic subject areas during the school day. Because the teachers are familiar with the Common Core standards, have access to curricular resources utilized in the regular school day, and are equipped to assess the needs of students. Teachers in these programs will utilize our curricula along with other aligned supplemental resources during instruction.

**Provide a description of the materials purchased to support implementation of ELT.**

To enhance student engagement and academic growth during Extended Learning Time, our school has invested in a variety of instructional and enrichment resources:

i-Ready Software: A comprehensive digital platform that provides personalized instruction in reading and mathematics, helping students build foundational skills through adaptive assessments and targeted lessons.

Ready Workbooks and Materials: These print resources complement the i-Ready software, offering structured practice and instructional support aligned with grade-level standards.

LEGO Robotics Kits: Hands-on STEM tools that promote critical thinking, problem-solving, and collaboration through engaging robotics and coding activities.

These materials are strategically selected to support differentiated instruction, reinforce core academic skills, and foster creativity and innovation during ELT sessions.

# Section 7: Parent and Family Engagement Policy and School-Parent Compact

## Parent and Family Engagement Policy

**Directions:** The Parent and Family Engagement Policy should describe how your school will plan and implement effective parent and family engagement activities and/or strategies to improve student academic achievement and school performance. The School-Parent Compact (SPC) is a component of the Parent and Family Engagement Policy (PFEP) that outlines how parents, the entire school staff, and students will share this responsibility.

The activities and/or strategies included in your school's Parent and Family Engagement Policy should align with current Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP) goals for improving student achievement and should be developed or updated with input and feedback from parent leaders and the Parent Coordinator. In addition, if the school community will be engaged in central parent engagement initiatives, such as Parent Academy, which will provide training for school communities to help strengthen family-school partnerships, please be sure to include these activities in the school's policy.

In Title I schools, the Title I Parent Advisory Council (PAC) represents the Title I parent community in supporting parent and family engagement. The Title I PAC Chairperson will serve in a consultative role with the SLT representing the school's Title I parents. Schools are encouraged to use the sample Parent and Family Engagement and SPC templates below (which meet federal Title I parent and family engagement requirements) as guidance for updating the school's current policy.

**Parent and Family Engagement Policy**

Educational research shows a positive correlation between effective parental engagement and student achievement. The overall aim of this policy is to develop a parent and family engagement policy that will establish expectations and objectives for meaningful parent and family engagement in the school community. P.S. 8M, in compliance with Section 1116 of Title I, Part A of the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), is responsible for creating and implementing a parent and family engagement policy to strengthen the connection and support of student achievement between the school and the families. The school's policy is designed to keep parents informed by actively involving them in planning and decision-making in support of the education of their children. Parents are encouraged to actively participate on the School Leadership Team, Parent Association (or Parent-Teacher Association), and Title I Parent Advisory Council as trained volunteers and welcomed members of the school community.

### Support for Parents and Family Members of Title I Students

P.S. 8M will support parents and family members of Title I students by:
- providing materials and training to help parents work with their children to improve their achievement level, e.g., literacy, math and use of technology;
- providing parents with the information and training needed to effectively become involved in planning and decision making in support of the education of their children;
- fostering a caring and effective home-school partnership to ensure that parents can effectively support and monitor their child's progress;
- providing assistance to parents in understanding City, State and Federal standards and assessments;
- sharing information about school and parent related programs, meetings and other activities in a format, and in languages that parents can understand;
- providing professional learning opportunities for school staff with the assistance of parents to improve outreach, communication skills and cultural competency in order to build stronger ties between parents and other members of the school community;

### Parental Involvement and School Quality

The school's Parent and Family Engagement Policy was designed based upon a careful assessment of the needs of all parents/guardians, including parents/guardians of Multilingual Learners/English Language Learners (ML/ELL), and students with disabilities. The school community, with the meaningful involvement of parents and family members, will conduct an annual evaluation of the content and effectiveness of this parent and family engagement policy with Title I parents to improve the academic quality of the school. The findings of the evaluation through school surveys and feedback forms will be used to design strategies to more effectively meet the needs of parents and family members and enhance the school's Title I program. This information will be maintained by the school.

In developing the Title I Parent and Family Engagement Policy, parents of Title I participating students, parent members of the school's Parent Association (or Parent-Teacher Association), as well as parent members of the School Leadership Team, were consulted on the proposed Title I Parent and Family Engagement Policy and asked to survey their members for additional input. To increase and improve parent involvement and school quality, the school will:
- actively involve and engage parents and family members in the planning, review and evaluation of the effectiveness of the school's Title I program as outlined in the School Comprehensive Education Plan, including the implementation of the school's Title I Parent and Family Engagement Policy and School-Parent Compact;
- engage all parents in discussion and decisions regarding the required Title I, 1% set-aside funds, which are allocated directly to the school to supplement parent and family engagement activities, including family literacy and parenting skills;
- ensure that the Title I funds allocated for parent and family engagement are utilized to implement activities and strategies as described in the school's Parent and Family Engagement Policy and the School-Parent Compact;
- support school-level committees that include parents who are members of the School Leadership Team, the Parent Association (or Parent-Teacher Association) and Title I Parent Advisory Council. This includes providing technical support and ongoing professional learning, especially in developing leadership skills;
- maintain a Parent Coordinator (or a dedicated staff person) to serve as a liaison between the school and families. The Parent Coordinator or a dedicated staff person will provide parent workshops based on the assessed needs of the parents of children who attend the school and will work to ensure that the school environment is welcoming and inviting to all parents. The Parent Coordinator will also maintain a log of events and activities planned for parents each month and file a report with the central office.;
- conduct parent workshops with topics that may include: parenting skills, understanding educational accountability grade-level curriculum and assessment expectations; literacy, accessing community and support services; and technology training to build parents' capacity to help their children at home;

- provide opportunities for parents to help them understand the accountability system, e.g., ESSA/State accountability system, student proficiency levels, Annual School Report Card, School Quality Report, Quality Review Report, Learning Environment Survey Report;
- host the required Annual Title I Parent Meeting each school year to advise parents of children participating in the Title I program about the school's Title I funded program(s), their right to be involved in the program and the parent and family engagement requirements under Title I, Part A, Section 1116 and other applicable sections under ESSA;
- schedule additional parent meetings, e.g., quarterly meetings, with flexible times, such as meetings in the morning or evening, to share information about the school's educational program and other initiatives of the Chancellor and allow parents to provide suggestions;
- translate all critical school documents and provide interpretation during meetings and events as needed.

### Encouraging School-Level Parental Involvement

The school will further encourage school-level parent and family engagement by:
- hosting educational family events/activities during Parent-Teacher Conferences and throughout the school year;
- encouraging meaningful parent participation on School Leadership Teams, Parent Association (or Parent-Teacher Association) and Title I Parent Advisory Council;
- supporting or hosting Family Day events;
- establishing a Parent Resource Center/Area or lending library; instructional materials for parents;
- encouraging more parents to become trained school volunteers;
- providing written and verbal progress reports that are periodically given to keep parents informed of their children's progress;
- developing and distributing a school newsletter or web publication designed to keep parents informed about school activities and student progress;
- providing school planners/folders for regular written communication between /teacher and the home in a format, and to the extent practicable in the languages that parents can understand.

# School-Parent Compact (SPC)

### School-Parent Compact (SPC)

P.S. 8M, in compliance with the Section 1116 of Title I, Part A of the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), is implementing a School-Parent Compact to strengthen the connection and support of student achievement between the school and the families. Staff and parents of students participating in activities and programs funded by Title I, agree that this Compact outlines how parents, the entire school staff and students will share responsibility for improved academic achievement and the means by which a school-parent partnership will be developed to ensure that all children achieve State Standards on assessments.

### I. School Responsibilities: High Quality CurriculumI. School Responsibilities: High Quality Curriculum

Provide high quality curriculum and instruction consistent with State Standards to enable participating children to meet the State's Standards and Assessments by:

- using academic learning time efficiently;
- respecting cultural, racial and ethnic differences;
- implementing a curriculum aligned to the State Learning Standards;
- offering high quality instruction in all content areas;
- providing instruction by highly qualified teachers and when this does not occur, notifying parents as required by the Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA)

### I. School Responsibilities: Supporting Home-School Relationships

Support home-school relationships and improve communication by:

- conducting parent-teacher conferences each semester during which the individual child's achievement will be discussed as well as how this Compact is related;
- convening an Annual Title I Parent Meeting each school year for parents and family members of students participating in the Title I program to inform them of the school's Title I status and funded programs and their right to be involved;
- arranging additional meetings at other flexible times, e.g., morning, evening and providing (if necessary and funds are available) transportation or child care for those parents who cannot attend a regular meeting;
- respecting the rights of limited English proficient families to receive translated documents and interpretation services in order to ensure participation in the child's education;
- providing information related to school and parent programs, meetings and other activities is sent to parents of participating children in a format and to the extent practicable in a language that parents can understand;
- involving parents in the planning process to review, evaluate and improve the existing Title I programs, Parent and Family Engagement Policy and this Compact;
- providing parents with timely information regarding performance profiles and individual student assessment results for each child and other pertinent individual school information;
- ensuring that the Parent and Family Engagement Policy and School-Parent Compact are distributed and discussed with parents each year;

### I. School Responsibilities: Providing Parents Reasonable Access to Staff

Provide parents reasonable access to staff by:
- ensuring that staff will have access to interpretation services in order to effectively communicate with limited English speaking parents;
- notifying parents of the procedures to arrange an appointment with their child's teacher or other school staff member;
- arranging opportunities for parents to receive training to volunteer and participate in their child's class, and to observe classroom activities;
- planning activities for parents during the school year, e.g., Parent-Teacher Conferences;

### I. School Responsibilities: Providing General Support to Parents

Provide general support to parents by:
- creating a safe, supportive and effective learning community for students and a welcoming respectful environment for parents, and guardians;
- assisting parents in understanding academic achievement standards and assessments and how to monitor their child's progress by providing professional learning opportunities (times will be scheduled so that the majority of parents can attend);
- sharing and communicating best practices for effective communication, collaboration and partnering with all members of the school community;
- supporting parental involvement activities as requested by parents and family members;
- ensuring that the Title I funds allocated for parent involvement are utilized to implement activities as described in this Compact and the Parent and Family Engagement Policy;
- advising parents of their right to file a complaint under the Department's General Complaint Procedures and consistent with the Title I requirement for Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) and Title I programs

### II. Parent/Guardian Responsibilities

- monitor my child's attendance and ensure that my child arrives to school on time as well as follow the appropriate procedures to inform the school when my child is absent;
- ensure that my child comes to school rested by setting a schedule for bedtime based on the needs of my child and his/her age;
- check and assist my child in completing homework tasks, when necessary;
- read to my child and/or discuss what my child is reading each day (for a minimum of 15 minutes);
- set limits to the amount of time my child watches television or plays video games;
- promote positive use of extracurricular time such as, extended day learning opportunities, clubs, team sports and/or quality family time;
- encourage my child to follow school rules and regulations and discuss this Compact with my child;
- volunteer in my child's school or assist from my home as time permits;
- participate, as appropriate, in the decisions relating to my child's education;
- communicate with my child's teacher about educational needs and stay informed about their education by prompting reading and responding to all notices received from the school or district;
- respond to surveys, feedback forms and notices when requested;
- become involved in the development, implementation, evaluation and revision to the Parent and Family Engagement Policy and this Compact;
- participate in or request training offered by the school, district, central and/or State Education Department to learn more about teaching and learning strategies whenever possible;
- take part in the school's Parent Association or Parent-Teacher Association or serve to the extent possible on

advisory groups, e.g., Title I Parent Advisory Council, School or District Leadership Teams;

- share responsibility for the improved academic achievement of my child

### III. Student Responsibilities

- attend school regularly and arrive on time;
- complete my homework and submit all assignments on time;
- follow the school rules and be responsible for my actions;
- show respect for myself, other people and property;
- try to resolve disagreements or conflicts peacefully;
- always try my best to learn.

# Title I Program Information

## Part 1: Title I Program Type

**Title I Requirements and Strengthening Title I Parent Involvement:** Under USDOE's Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA), Title I schools are required to address professional learning and parent and family engagement in the Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP). To strengthen parent leadership in Title I schools, and increase the involvement of all parents of Title I eligible children in improving students' academic outcomes, all Title I schools are required to establish a Title I Parent Advisory Council (PAC) that will serve as the consultative and representative body for all Title I parents in the school to provide voice into the spending of Title I funds.

The SLT is responsible for facilitating consultation with the Title I Parent Advisory Council regarding the joint development of the CEP, Parent and Family Engagement Policy, School Parent Compact (SPC) and the use of the 1% parent involvement set-aside in Title I schools. The Title I Parent Advisory Council (PAC) Chairperson (or alternate) is expected to attend all regular meetings of the School Leadership Team (SLT). Title I parents, as represented by the Title I PAC Chairperson, must be consulted regarding the use of the Title I 1% set-aside for parent and family engagement. The Title I 1% set-aside funding is used to supplement parent and family engagement activities as described in the school's Parent and Family Engagement Policy and must be aligned with student achievement goals as outlined in the CEP. For additional guidance on the Title I Parent Advisory Council (PAC), go to the Protocols and Timeline for Title I Parent and Family Engagement Activities document.

Directions:

- All schools must indicate their Title I status in Part 1.
- All elements of the All Title I Schools section must be completed in Part 2.
- All Targeted Assistance (TA) Schools must also complete the TA Schools Only section in Part 3.
- All Schoolwide Program (SWP) schools must also complete the SWP Schools Only section in Part 4.
- If a required component is addressed elsewhere in this plan, you may refer to the section or Priority where the response can be found.
- For additional information, visit the Title I Program Description (US Department of Education).

**Your school's Title I Program**

Title I SWP

# Part 2: All Title I Schools

**High Quality and Ongoing Professional Learning: Please list below the Priority or section(s) that indicate strategies and activities for high quality professional learning for teachers, principals, staff, and paraprofessionals to enable all students to meet state standards.**

Priority Areas Supporting Professional Learning:

Priority 1: Rigorous Instruction and Academic Achievement
Strategies include collaborative planning, data-driven instruction, and professional development in differentiation and project-based learning.

Priority 2: Social Emotional Learning and Student Well-Being
Staff receive training in trauma-informed practices and SEL frameworks through partnerships with mental health providers.

Priority 4: Inclusive Practices and Equity
Professional learning focuses on culturally responsive pedagogy, support for ELLs and SWDs, and equity-focused PLCs.

Priority 5: MTSS and Intervention Systems
Training in MTSS implementation, progress monitoring, and tiered interventions is provided to teachers and paraprofessionals.

Title I and Family Engagement
Title I funds support PD in family engagement strategies and culturally responsive communication.

Professional Learning Activities:

Weekly grade-level team meetings for instructional planning and data analysis
Monthly school-wide PD aligned to CEP goals
Coaching cycles with instructional leads and consultants
Participation in district-led workshops and inter-school learning networks

# Part 4: Schoolwide Program (SWP)

**Transition Plans to Assist Preschool Children (Elementary Schools Only): Describe the transition plans used to assist preschool children from early childhood programs to the elementary school program (e.g. aligned curriculum, joint PD & parent involvement activities, sharing of records/information, early intervention services, etc.).**

P.S. 8M serves students from 3K through 5th grade and has developed a comprehensive transition plan to support preschool children as they move into the elementary school program. The following strategies are in place:

1. Aligned Curriculum and Instructional Practices:

Early childhood educators and kindergarten teachers collaborate to ensure curriculum alignment across domains including literacy, numeracy, and social-emotional development.
Instructional planning includes shared goals and developmental benchmarks to support continuity in learning.

2. Joint Professional Development:

Teachers across grade levels participate in joint PD sessions focused on early childhood pedagogy, developmentally appropriate practices, and trauma-informed instruction.
PD is supported by partnerships with organizations such as the Children's Aid Society.

3. Family Engagement and Orientation Activities:

Families are invited to participate in transition workshops, classroom visits, and orientation sessions to familiarize themselves with kindergarten expectations.
The Parent Coordinator facilitates ongoing communication and support for families during the transition period.

4. Sharing of Records and Student Information:

Preschool teachers share student portfolios, assessment data, and anecdotal records with kindergarten staff to ensure a smooth academic and social transition.
Early identification of needs allows for timely intervention and support planning.

5. Early Intervention Services:

Students identified with developmental delays or learning needs receive early intervention services through collaboration with school-based support teams and external providers.
Referrals and service continuity are coordinated to minimize disruption in support.

6. Social-Emotional Support Structures:

SEL programs are integrated across grade levels to help students build relationships, regulate emotions, and adapt to new routines.
School counselors and mental health partners provide targeted support for students experiencing transition-related anxiety.

# Part 5: "Conceptual" Consolidation of Funds in SWP Schools

**Directions:** All Schoolwide Program (SWP) schools in NYC are conceptually consolidating their Federal, State, and Local funds, even though the Galaxy system reports the allocations in separate accounting codes1. To be eligible for the flexibility consolidation of Federal funds, a Schoolwide Program school must identify in its Schoolwide plan (CEP) which programs are included in its consolidation and the amount each program contributes to the consolidated Schoolwide pool. Additionally, the school plan must document that it has met the intent and purposes of each program whose funds are consolidated2. **On the chart below**, indicate which Federal, State, and/or local Tax Levy program funds that are consolidated in your school's Schoolwide Program, the amount each program contributes to the consolidated Schoolwide pool, and verification that the school has met the intent and purposes of each program whose funds are consolidated.
For the last two columns of this table: Place an (X) in Column A below to verify that the school has met the intent and purposes of each program whose funds are consolidated. Indicate in Column B, the Priority or section that references where a related program activity has been described in this plan.

| Program Name | Fund Source (i.e. Federal, State or Local) | Funding Amount: Indicate the amount contributed to Schoolwide pool. (Refer to Galaxy for school allocation amounts) | Column A Verify with an (X) | Column B Section/Priority Reference(s) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Title I, Part A (Basic) | Federal | 312,297 | X | |
| Title I, School Improvement 1003(a) | Federal | | | |
| Title II, Part A | Federal | 37,864 | X | |
| Title III, Part A | Federal | 15,040 | X | |
| Title III, Immigrant | Federal | | | |
| Title IV, Part A | Federal | 6,913 | X | |
| Tax Levy (Fair Student | Local | 3,252,760 | X | |

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Funding) | | | | |

# Explanation/Background

**1. Explanation/Background:**

Title I Schoolwide Program schools are expected to use the flexibility available to them to integrate services and programs with the aim of enhancing the entire educational program and helping all students reach proficient and advanced levels of achievement. In addition to coordinating and integrating services, Schoolwide Program schools may combine most Federal, State and local funds to provide those services. By consolidating funds from Federal, State, and local sources, a Schoolwide Program school can address its needs using all its available resources. This gives a school more flexibility in how it uses available resources to meet the identified needs of all its students.

Consolidating funds in a Schoolwide Program means that a school treats the funds it is consolidating like they are a single "pool" of funds. In other words, the funds from the contributing programs in the school lose their individual identity and the school has one flexible pool of funds. The school uses funds from this consolidated Schoolwide pool to support any activity of the Schoolwide Program without regard to which program contributed the specific funds used for a particular activity – so long as the use of funds meets the intent and purposes of the programs from which the funds originate. To consolidate funding in a Schoolwide Program, the school does not literally need to combine funds in a single account or pool with its own accounting code. Rather, the word "pool" is used conceptually to convey that a Schoolwide Program school has the use of all consolidated funds available to it for the dedicated function of operating a Schoolwide Program without regard to the identity of those funds.

Consolidating Federal funds in a Schoolwide Program has the following additional advantages:

- Consolidating Federal funds eases the requirements for accounting for funds from each specific program separately, because a Schoolwide school is not required to distinguish among funds received from different sources when accounting for their use.
- A school that consolidates Federal funds in its Schoolwide Program is not required to meet most of the statutory and regulatory requirements of the specific Federal programs included in the consolidation (e.g., semi-annual time and effort reporting for Title I). However, the school must ensure that it meets the intent and purposes of the Federal programs included in the consolidation so that the needs of the intended beneficiaries are met.

2. The intent and purposes of the Federal programs indicated on the chart above (Part 4c of this section) are as follows:

- **Title I, Part A – Schoolwide Programs:** To upgrade the entire educational program in the school in order to improve the academic achievement of all students, particularly the lowest-achieving students. This includes provision of services for Students in Temporary Housing (STH).
- **Title I 1003(a), School Improvement: Comprehensive Support and Improvement (CSI), Additional Targeted Support and Improvement (ATSI) and Targeted Support and Improvement (TSI) Funding:**

Support implementation of school improvement plans that aims to improve instruction and address the identified needs

**Title II, Part A:** Supplementary funding to improve student academic achievement by reducing class size in grades K, 1, 2, and 3, with an emphasis on grades with an average register greater than 20. If space is not available to form additional classes, funds may support push-in teacher(s) to supplement the instructional program. For schools that choose to reduce class size, priority must be given to reducing class size in general education settings and must demonstrate the following:

- Reduce class sizes to 15-18 students or fewer (including the use of co-teaching and floating teachers that bring the student to teacher ratio to one teacher per 15-18 students);
- Be accompanied by a rigorous curriculum, effective teachers, and a sustained, job-embedded professional development plan.

- **Title III, Part A:** To help ensure that children with limited English proficiency become proficient in English, develop high academic attainment in English, and meet the same challenging State academic content and achievement standards in the core academic subjects that all other children are expected to meet. Another purpose of this program is to increase the capacity of schools to establish, implement and sustain high-quality language instruction programs and English language development programs that assist schools in effectively teaching students with limited English proficiency. Title III, Part A is also designed to promote the participation of parents and communities of limited English proficient children in English language instruction programs.
- **Title III Immigrant**: Supplementary and enhanced services to immigrant students, in the areas of English language acquisition and content area achievement. Immigrant children and youth are defined as individuals who are aged 3 through 21, have not been attending school in any one or more states for more than three (3) full academic years, and were not born in any state. "State" means the 50 states of the United States, the District of Columbia, and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico. Children born to U.S. citizens abroad, the U.S. Virgin Islands, or any other U.S. territory that is not D.C. or Puerto Rico are to be considered immigrants.
- **Title IV, Part A**: Title IV funds are for schools that are among those with the greatest needs, have the highest numbers of students from low-income families, are identified for CS, ATSI or TSI, or are identified as persistently dangerous public schools. Allowable uses of funds under well-rounded education, safety and health, and educational technology include direct services for students, professional development for teachers and administrators, and supplemental educational resources. School allocations have been provided for well-rounded education, social emotional learning, cultural responsiveness awareness, professional development to support implementation of technology and blended learning environments, and community coordinators in schools with high rates of students in temporary housing

- Students in Temporary Housing (STH): Schools must describe their use of Title I STH funds in their consolidated application.

Important Note: The following funds may not be consolidated:

- **Title I Parent Involvement Set-aside:** Title I, Part A funds must support parent involvement activities and programs. Chancellor's Regulation A-655 requires School Leadership Teams to consult with Title I parent representatives regarding the Title I program and the use of these funds. Parent involvement activities funded through Title I must be included in the Parent and Family Engagement Policy and aligned with student achievement goals in the school comprehensive educational plan.
- **IDEA:** To ensure that all children with disabilities have available to them a free appropriate public education designed to meet their individual needs.
- **Grant funds awarded via a competitive process:** These funds must be used for the purposes specified by the Grantor, as described in the school's approved grant application.

# Community Schools

## Community School Partners

NYC Community Schools are committed to advancing equity by organizing resources and sharing leadership with community partners to support the whole child. Each Community School is different and reflects the strengths and needs of its students, families, and local community. The most successful Community Schools share common features, which are integrated into the fabric of the school and drive student learning. These features are Collaborative Leadership and Practice, Family and Community Engagement, Expanded Learning Time (ELT), and Wellness and Integrated Supports. Embedded throughout the work is a focus on incorporating anti-racist practices and differentiating supports, including attendance supports, for special populations. Since all school operations and actions are in service of improving the academic and non-academic achievement of its students, the annual schoolwide goals should be informed by the students, their achievement, and the opportunities provided to them. The school should develop these goals after a realistic and comprehensive analysis of its data, paying specific attention to the achievement of its subgroups and disproportionality.

**Directions: Identify the partnerships with Community-Based Organizations (CBOs) that will support the achievement of annual goals through implementation of the Community School Core Features: Collaborative Leadership and Practice, Family and Community Engagement, Expanded Learning Time (ELT), and Wellness and Integrated Supports. Identify the target student population(s), provide a summary of the scope of the services and indicate the Priority or section(s) of the plan.**

| CBO Partners | Target Population | Scope of Service | Priority/section(s) and Annual Goal |
|---|---|---|---|
| Children's Aid | All students | Full service | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

# Implementation of Community School Core Features & Components

**Collaborative Leadership and Practice: Describe how the CBO will share leadership and engage in collaborative planning with the Community School to achieve the school's annual goals.**

At PS 8 we have a full-time Community School Director (CSD) that regularly participates in the School Leadership Team, which is responsible for the development of the school's Comprehensive Education Plan. In addition, the Community School Director, or designee, is a member of the Safety Committee and Child Study Team. School Principal and CSD hold regularly scheduled meetings, as well as, other appropriate personnel, to discuss all issues pertaining to the after-school programing, summer rising program, early childhood programming, medical, mental health and parent programming. Shared leadership is key to successful programming at PS 8, which helps to ensure ongoing coordination. CA also has an Educational Coordinator, a DOE day-school teacher who oversees the integration of the after-school program with the school day curriculum. CA and DOE staff will attend joint staff development sessions. Finally, CA staff and the Educational Coordinators regularly consult with teachers to discuss curricular issues and individual students.

**Family and Community Engagement: Describe how your Community School will develop authentic school-family partnerships, and create the conditions for families and community members to participate in decision-making, hold leadership roles that drive school change, and serve as partners in students' holistic development.**

Central to the Children's Aid community school model are Parent Resource Centers where parents are welcomed and encouraged to get involved in their children's education by taking adult education classes, getting advice and support on how to help their children succeed in school, and by meeting other parents to create their own programs, support groups and activities. These parent rooms become places in schools where parents can socialize, advocate and organize, participate in workshops, and plan community-wide celebrations and events.

At PS 8, The Luis Belliard School, we strongly believe that parental engagement is essential for the academic success of our children. The School Administrators, Teachers, Staff, Parents, and The Children's Aid share responsibility in ensuring that our children reach their fullest social and academic potential. PS 8 is a Community School that fosters family and school connections, through cooperation and communication between families and school staff. Our Community School consists of multiple resources to create a caring learning environment, where children and families are welcomed for Family Literacy opportunities, Adult Education, Preventive Services, Early Childhood Programming, Parenting Skills Training, and school wide activities. Our school wide activities are designed with attention to cultural and social needs.

# Implementation of Community School Core Features & Components

**Wellness and Integrated Supports: Describe how your Community School will address out-of-school barriers to learning through partnerships with social and health service agencies and providers to help students attend school regularly and engage in learning through the provision of programs such as social emotional learning, conflict resolution training, and restorative justice.**

The CA community schools model seeks to promote children's learning and development in ways that prepare them for productive adulthood. Recognizing that children's learning and development is influenced by their ongoing experiences in their families, schools and communities, CA community schools work to integrate the efforts of all three of these major influences through a partnership approach that addresses five sets of outcome domains: students; families; school; community; and education policy.

Parents, youth and other community residents are actively involved in all aspects of community schools, starting with a needs assessment process that initiates each school. The Student Resource Coordinator and Teachers meet in the beginning of the school year in order to complete initial needs assessment and whole class reviews, focused on identifying gaps in services, student need and strengths.

**Every Student, Every Day: Describe how your Community School will work with CBO partners to meet weekly and use data from DOE systems and New Visions for Public Schools to monitor trends in attendance, assign personalized interventions–including Success Mentors–to chronically absent students, and draw on community resources for support with removing barriers to attendance.**

For support, you may access strategies here.

The CA Community School model recognizes that students cannot learn if basic social, emotional, and physical needs are not met. Schools have many services available to meet these needs but are unable to provide the full range of services each child needs to engage and thrive in school. Urban neighborhoods are often service-rich and most support for students can be found in the community. However, schools require the infrastructure, personnel, and expertise to effectively engage community partners to provide services to students that meet individual student needs.
The CA Student Resource Coordinator is the main contact within the school for outreach, communication, and coordination with community partners to ensure optimum service delivery. She works closely with community partners to provide services that support the academic achievement and healthy development of students. Services and supports range from enrichment/prevention, early intervention, and intensive interventions. Some connections with community partners are already in place through past work of CA (and, in some cases, through the work of the school).
The benefit of implementing the CA model at PS 8 is that it is a Full Service Community School. PS 8 has a host of resources that provide students and their families access to a myriad of services, including a school-based health clinic which provides medical care, annual physical exams, dental examinations, vision screenings, and a partnership with the Helen Keller Institute to provide eye glasses when needed.
Additionally,PS 8 has a Community Schools Department that orchestrates the services provided to students and their families. A mental health clinician provides individual and group counseling and works with parents when necessary.

Our Student Resource provides additional social skills groups. We also have an After School Director that coordinates all out of school time activities which includes seven weeks of summer program and 13 days of Holiday programming.

**Special Populations: Describe how your Community School will work with your partners to ensure students receive differentiated and culturally responsive supports. Describe how your Community School's systems and structures will be optimized to work for <u>all</u> students, including students in temporary housing, Multilingual Learner/English Language Learner (ML/ELL), and Students with Disabilities.**

While the Community School concept allows for an innovative vision of the role a school can play within the community, its primary goal is to promote children's learning and development. In the CA model, expanded educational, health, social and recreation services at the school includes: an extended-day program that offers educational enrichment before school, after school, weekends and summers; medical, dental, mental health and social services; a comprehensive parent involvement program; early childhood education; adult education; and community-wide events.

Students who are identified by the Community School Director and School Principal for individualized or small group instruction receive support from CA Academic Specialists, school day teachers who work as part of the education team in our afterschool program and provide specialized academic coaching to targeted subgroups of children. Students entering a coaching group evaluated using the Common Core Reading Program, published by RALLY! Education. Their progress in the group is documented using the results of the STAR early literacy test, which is administered on a bi-monthly basis to determine instructional needs and tailor lesson plans.

# Expanded Learning Time (ELT)

Describe how your Community School will offer opportunities for enrichment through after-school, weekend, and summer programs, as well as additional instruction, individualized academic support, and enrichment activities that emphasize real-world learning and community problem solving.

Refer to the Multi-Tiered Systems of Support (MTSS) section of the CEP for the ELT program description indicating how the school's ELT program is offered to all eligible students considered to be at-risk of not meeting state standards.

# Submission Assurances

## Submission Assurances

- ☐ The Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP) has been developed in consultation with parents, school staff, and others in accordance with the requirements of Shared-Decision Making (CR 100.11) to provide a meaningful opportunity for stakeholders to participate in the development of the plan and comment on the plan before it is approved.
- ☐ As part of the root cause analysis process, the school reviewed inequities, including resource inequities within the school, and investigated areas of low performance to identify strategies to address inequities within the school and promote improved student outcomes.
- ☐ The CEP School Leadership Team (SLT)/Stakeholder Signature Page will be printed, scanned, and submitted with the signatures of those that participated in the development of the CEP. DocuSign may also be used to secure electronic signatures for the CEP SLT/Stakeholder Signature Page. If the school was unable to obtain a signature of an individual that participated in the development of the CEP, the school has written “Addendum Attached” and provided supplemental documentation to explain why the school was unable to obtain the individual’s signature.
- ☐ The CEP will be implemented no later than the beginning of the first day of regular student attendance.
- ☐ Professional development will be provided to teachers and school leaders that will fully support the strategic efforts described within this plan.

# Language Allocation Policy Outline

## Language Allocation Policy Outline

**2025-26 Language Allocation Policy (LAP)**

This submission form supports schools with organizing a well-conceived school-based Language Allocation Policy (LAP) that describes high quality programs for Multilingual Learners/English Language Learners (MLs/ELLs). This is an annual plan of how your school will support the linguistic and academic needs of MLs/ELLs and must be completed yearly. The Language Allocation Policy (LAP) is a part of schools' Comprehensive Education Plan (CEP).

This is a living document. Any school-wide changes involving the instruction of MLs/ELLs, such as the addition or expansion of a Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) or Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE) program, should be updated in this form.

Agenda, minutes of LAP meetings, and LAP team members' attendance at meetings should be kept readily available on file in the school with all other ML/ELL critical documents.  When preparing your school's submission, provide extended responses in the available spaces.

For additional information, refer to the NYC DOE Policy and Reference Guide for MLs/ELLs. For additional support with ML/ELL policy, please reach out to your respective ML/ELL Director or ELL Compliance Performance Specialist; for support with ML/ELL instruction, please contact your ML/ELL Services Administrator.

# Part I: School ML/ELL Profile

This section should reflect the school's demographics for the 2025-26 school year. If completing before the 2025-26 school year begins, questions should be based on the anticipated population served by the school.

# A. Language Allocation Policy Team Composition

The members of the school's LAP team are listed below. A school's LAP team must consist of at least one: principal, assistant principal (where applicable), an English as a New Language (ENL) teacher, an additional teacher (bilingual teacher if the school has a bilingual program or a teacher from a content area other than bilingual education or ENL) and a parent/guardian.

**Required LAP team members are denoted with an asterisk (*) below. Please do not leave any fields blank. If a role is not represented on the LAP team, include "N/A" below.**

| Member Title | Name |
|---|---|
| Principal* | Washington Hernandez |
| Assistant Principal (Where Applicable)* | Wiley Nelson-Dinnal |
| English as a New Language (ENL) Teacher* | Joanna Matos |
| Teacher (if school has a bilingual program must be a bilingual teacher)* | Heilin Capellan |
| Parent/Guardian* | Eunice Rivera |
| ENL Teacher | Eleni Filippatos |
| Bilingual Teacher | Sheila Caro |
| School Social Worker | Ada Suriel |
| Special Education Teacher | Micaela Rudykoff |
| Common Branch Teacher | Sonelis Severino |
| Common Branch Teacher | Glenda Garcia |
| Instructional Coach | Peggy Montalvo |

# B. Teacher Qualifications

Please review all certifications for all staff members at your school, and indicate the number of certified staff for each category.

# 1. English to Speakers of Other Languages (ESOL) Certified Teacher

**Number of ESOL certified teachers currently teaching ENL:**

3

**Number of teachers currently teaching a stand-alone ENL class who hold both a common branch license and ESOL certification [applicable to grades K–6]:**

3

**Number of certified ESOL teachers not currently teaching ENL:**

3

**Number of teachers who hold both content area/common branch and ESOL certification:**

6

**Number of ESOL certified teachers with a bilingual extension:**

4

# 2. Certified Teachers with a Bilingual Extension

**Number of certified teachers with a bilingual extension currently teaching in a bilingual program:**

6

**Number of certified teachers with a bilingual extension not currently teaching in a bilingual program:**

4

**Number of teachers certified to teach students with disabilities that also have a bilingual extension:**

1

# 3. Language Other than English (LOTE)/World Language Certified Teachers:

**Total number of teachers with LOTE certification:**

0

**Total number of teachers with LOTE certification providing World Language instruction:**

0

**Total number of teachers with LOTE certification providing Home Language Arts (HLA) to students in bilingual programs:**

0

# C. Student Demographics

Please review the student demographics at your school and complete the number and percentage for each category.

**Total number of students (excluding pre-K):**

302

**Total number and percentage (%) of current ELLs:**

122, 40.4%

**Total number and percentage (%) of former ELLs:**

22, 7.28%

**Total number and percentage (%) of ELLs who are Newcomers (0-3 years of service):**

116, 86.6%

**Total number and percentage (%) of ELLs who are Developing ELLs (4-6 years of service):**

18, 13.4%

**Total number and percentage (%) of ELLs who are Long-Term ELLs (7 or more years of service):**

0, 0%

**Total number and percentage (%) of ELLs who are Students with Inconsistent/Interrupted Formal Education (SIFE):**

3, 2.5%

**Total number and percentage (%) of ELLs with an Individualized Education Program (IEP):**

24, 19.7%

# Part II: Bilingual Programs

**Does your school have a bilingual program (Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) or Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE)?**

Yes

**Provide the number of classrooms for each bilingual program, by grade, at your school for the 2025-26 school year. If submitted before the 2025-26 school year begins, this should be the anticipated number of classrooms based on anticipated enrollment. Each language and program model--Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) or Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE)--is considered a separate program. In the second column, please indicate if the program is General Education (GE), Integrated Co-Teaching (ICT) special education, Special Class (SC), or Mixed-Group Class (MGC) special education. If a classroom bridges two grades, list as 0.5 classrooms for both grades.**
**Please include the total number of classrooms for each bilingual program in the last column.**

| | Program Type | Language | School Yr Opened | k | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | Totals |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| TBE | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 0 |
| TBE | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 0 |
| TBE | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 0 |
| DLBE | General Education | Spanish | 2000 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 1 | | | | | | | | 6 |
| DLBE | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 0 |
| DLBE | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | 0 |
| | | | | total: 1 | total: 1 | total: 1 | total: 1 | total: 1 | total: 1 | total: 0 | total: 0 | total: 0 | total: 0 | total: 0 | total: 0 | total: 0 | |

# Part III: ML/ELL Programming

Please refer to New York State **Commissioner's Regulation (CR) Part 154 Units of Study Tables** as you describe academic programming for MLs/ELLs at your school below. Please do not leave any fields blank and indicate "N/A" for any fields that are not applicable.

Describe your English as a New Language (ENL), and if applicable Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE), and Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) programs. For each program, include:

- How stand-alone ENL is implemented as per CR Part 154
- How integrated ENL is implemented as per CR Part 154
- How students are grouped (e.g., block [class travels together as a group], ungraded [all students regardless of grade are in one class], heterogeneous [mixed proficiency levels], homogenous [proficiency level is the same in one class]).

**a. English as a New Language (ENL)**
**Stand-alone ENL:**

Two out of classroom English as a New Language (ENL) teachers, Joanna Matos and Heilin Capellan, provide Stand-alone instruction using a pull-out model, to the entering and emerging students in the monolingual classrooms. Heilin Capellan is assigned to the kindergarten ICT,  2/3 self-contained, and grades 2,3,5 classes. Joanna Matos is not providing pull-out during the 2025-2026 school year. We also have one stand-alone ENL class grouped heterogeneously and by grade. The Grade 1 ENL self-contained class is taught by Tabitha Perez (ESOL and Common Branch license). Tabitha Perez provides small group Stand-alone ENL in the classroom.

**Integrated ENL:**

Two out of classroom English as a New Language (ENL) teachers, Joanna Matos and Heilin Capellan are co-teaching with general education teachers in the monolingual classrooms. One ENL certified teacher teaches content areas in the monolingual ENL classroom  (Tabitha Perez, Grade 1) for one unit of study (a minimum of 180 minutes), during literacy instruction to support English language learners. The ENL teachers and classroom teachers plan collaboratively to ensure that ELL students are provided with the necessary scaffolds for the lessons.

Classes are organized according to the language proficiency levels as per the NYSESLAT and NYSITELL scores and instruction is provided according to the program model as per CR Part 154.2. We have established a Freestanding ENL class in first grade. This model offers the opportunity to differentiate instruction according to student's needs and improve achievement gains in all subject areas.

Student are grouped heterogeneously and blocked by grade level to ensure a balanced mix of abilities, learning styles, and backgrounds.

**b. Bilingual Education (If applicable)**
**Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE):**

N/A

**Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE):**

Our school offers a Dual Language (DL) program in each grade. Teachers in the DL program are dually-certified (bilingual extension and common branch licenses) and engage in a 50/50 model of instruction in English and Spanish, supporting the development of both languages. In Dual Language classrooms (one per grade level), Bilingual certified teachers also provide stand-alone ENL services (180 minutes) to those students at the Entering and Emerging levels. ENL and bilingual services are provided in our DL classes by the classroom teacher in the following classes: Rhodes Guerrero (Kindergarten), Raquel Mesa (1st grade), Sheila Caro (2nd grade), Damaris Almonte (3rd grade), Angelica Diaz-Silvestre (4th grade) and Hilda Mirabal (5th grade).

The ELLs in the Dual Language program are grouped heterogeneously (all proficiency levels are represented in the class) and blocked with their grade level. To ensure that the mandated number of integrated ENL instructional minutes is provided, we use the Guidelines from CR Part 154.2. Integrated services are provided by the dual language classroom teacher during the literacy block.

**2. How does your school ensure the mandated number of instructional minutes are provided according to students' English language proficiency levels in each program model?**

Schedules for ENL/bilingual services are made using the most current proficiency levels following guidelines from CR Part 154.2. Each September, the ENL coordinator prints the RLAT from ATS to determine the number of mandated minutes required for each ELL student. Using this data, the ENL teachers Joanna Matos and Eleni Filippatos along with Assistant Principal Wiley Nelson-Dinnal program the mandated minutes in STARS Classroom by class and group.

At the beginning of the school year, all teachers of ELLs receive a class list with the NYSESLAT proficiency levels of students in their class along with the CR Part 154-2 ENL Units of Study and Staffing Requirements table. Schedules for out-of-classroom ENL teachers reflect the amount of mandated minutes for ELLs in a particular class and identify the ELL subgroups in each class. Classroom teachers' (bilingual and self-contained ENL) also reflect the mandated instructional minutes for their ELLs indicating Integrated ENL during their ELA block and dedicated stand-alone ENL instruction during the small group centers block.

In our Freestanding Self-Contained ENL Program, we ensure that a teacher who is certified in TESOL provides the mandated number of instructional minutes. All students in this model, regardless of proficiency level receive at least 180 minutes of integrated ENL instruction during the Literacy Block. The students in this program at the Entering and Emerging levels receive 180 minutes of Stand Alone ENL instruction in small groups.

In our Integrated ENL Program two out-of-classroom teachers provide the mandated number of instructional minutes through a co-teaching model. (A certified ENL out-of-classroom provider and common branch/special education teacher). All students in this model, regardless of proficiency level, receive at least 180 minutes of integrated ENL instruction in ELA and/or other content areas.

In the Stand-Alone ENL Program, a certified ENL provider provides the mandated number of instructional minutes to entitled students through a pull-out model. The students in this model at the Entering and Emerging levels receive 180 minutes of additional ENL Stand-Alone instruction support in small groups.

In our Dual Language, we ensure that a dual-certified teacher (common branch with a bilingual extension certification) provides the mandated number of instructional minutes. The students in this model receive 180 minutes of integrated ENL during literacy and content area instruction. The students in this model at the Entering and Emerging levels receive 180 minutes of additional ENL Stand-Alone support during small group instruction.

Explicit ENL, ELA, and HLA instructional minutes are delivered in each program model as delineated in CR Part 154.2. In our Freestanding, Integrated, and Stand-Alone ENL programs, students receive ELA instruction during the literacy block. ENL methodologies are used to support ELL students in the classroom.

In the Dual Language classes, instructional time for ELA and HLA are divided equally, alternating units of study in Spanish and English using the Expeditionary Learning literacy curricula. During ELA instruction, ENL methodologies are used to support the ELLs in the classroom. Pacing calendars reflect which units are taught in English and Spanish.

**3. How are ENL, English Language Arts (ELA) and if applicable, Home Language Arts (HLA) instructional minutes delivered in each program model?**

Explicit ENL, ELA, and HLA instructional minutes are delivered in each program model as delineated in CR Part 154.2. In our Freestanding, Integrated, and Stand-Alone ENL programs, students receive ELA instruction during the literacy block, 2 periods a day (totaling 100 minutes). ENL methodologies are used to support ELL students in the classroom.

In the Dual Language classes, instructional time for ELA and HLA are divided equally, alternating units of study in Spanish and English using the Expeditionary Learning literacy curricula. During ELA instruction, ENL methodologies are used to support the ELLs in the classroom. Pacing calendars reflect which units are taught in English and Spanish. Native language is used as a scaffold during literacy to activate background knowledge, vocabulary development including cognate instruction, and using translanguaging to allow students to fully demonstrate their content knowledge.

ELA instruction includes a foundational skills block in grades K-3, a literacy block (reading and writing) in all grades, and a small-group literacy centers block across all grades. ESOL-certified teachers and bilingual teachers provide integrated ENL support during the literacy blocks. Pull-out stand-alone instruction is scheduled during first and last period to minimize disruptions to core subject areas.

**4. For schools with Dual Language Bilingual Education (DLBE) programs:**

**a. Which Dual Language Bilingual Education model is implemented? Explain how much of the instructional day (percentage) English proficient students and ELLs are integrated.**

The Dual Language model implemented is a Spanish One-Way Immersion, self-contained, 50/50 model. English proficient students and ELLs are integrated for 100% of the instructional day.

Literacy instruction will alternate units of study in English (ELA) and Spanish (HLA). Math units will also alternate between English and Spanish. When the literacy unit is being taught in English, the math unit will be taught in Spanish, and vice versa. For newcomer ELLs, Illustrative Math and Expeditionary Learning Literacy will always be available as a native language support. For grades K-2, emergent literacy skills in both languages will be taught every day, using Fundations, Heggerty, Imagine Español, and Aprendo Leyendo.

For the entirety of the school year, Science will be taught in English using Amplify Science, while Social Studies will be taught in Spanish using Passport to Social Studies and other instructional resources. Linguistic summaries of the lessons will be provided in each lesson to support the development in both languages of the lessons will be provided in each lesson to support the development in both languages.

**b. In which language(s) is each core content area taught?**

Literacy and Math content will be taught equally in Spanish and English using an alternating unit schedule. Science will be taught in English and Social Studies will be taught in Spanish.

**5. For schools with Transitional Bilingual Education (TBE) programs:**

**a. Which core content areas are taught bilingually?**

N/A

# Part IV: Data Analysis

## Data Analysis

After reviewing and analyzing school demographic and assessment data, answer the following questions. The ELL Data Analysis Tool (EDAT) provided by the Office of Multilingual Learners can assist with identifying these data points.

For additional information, refer to Data Analysis Professional Learning Module and ELL Data Analysis Tool (EDAT) Professional Learning Module.

**1. What is the composition of the ELL subgroups at your school?**
**What percentage of ELLs are Newcomers? How does effective instruction for Newcomers differ from those provided to Developing or Long-Term ELLs?**

86.5% of ELLs are Newcomers. Different scaffolds are provided based on linguistic abilities. For Newcomers in dual language programs, native language phonics curriculum, Aprendo Leyendo, is used to strengthen foundational skills in Spanish. Imagine Espanol is a digital program utilized to further support reading skills in Spanish. Additionally, we use small group instruction to target English language development for Newcomers utilizing visuals, partner discussion, vocabulary development, sentence frames, and word banks. Newcomers at the Entering and Emerging level receive Stand-Alone ENL instruction from their certified bilingual teachers, which is dedicated within teachers' daily schedules. Additionally, Newcomers are targeted in groups based on their English proficiency levels in our after school Title III program, where instruction is focused on developing all four modalities.

Newcomers are supported through a variety of language supports and instructional scaffolds tailored to their English proficiency levels to ensure access to grade-level content. Teachers use many strategies like visuals, modeling, sentence frames, and graphic organizers. Students also work collaboratively, this gives them opportunities to practice language in meaningful ways while engaging with grade level work. In addition, students are provided with small group interventions, technological resources, bilingual materials and access to native language supports.

**What percentage of ELLs are Students with Inconsistent/Interrupted Formal Education (SIFE)? How do you differentiate effective instruction for SIFE?**

2.5% of ELLs are Students with Inconsistent /Interrupted Formal Education (SIFE). For those identified SIFE students, along with a few identified at-risk SIFE students not formally identified (i.e. students who entered in second grade with interrupted schooling), our out-of-classroom ENL teachers provide small group pull-out intervention with the Escalera curriculum which is designed to accelerate academic language and literacy development for students with interrupted education. Intervention includes explicit vocabulary instruction, oral language development, reading comprehension strategies, and writing scaffolds.

To measure the effectiveness of the intervention, we use a combination of, formative assessments built into the Escalera program, student work samples, growth on class work and teacher observations.

**What percentage of ELLs are Long-Term ELLs? How does effective instruction for Long-Term ELLs differ from instruction designed for Developing ELLs?**

0% of ELLs are Long-Term ELLs. As an elementary school, we service ELLs in Kindergarten through 5th grade. These students are not enrolled in school for 7 years and therefore cannot be identified as Long-Term ELLs (7 or more years of ENL service). Although 0% of ELLs are Long-Term ELLs, 13.4%of ELLs at P.S. 8 are Developing ELLs. Developing ELLS are provided with targeted interventions and scaffolds in the area or skill they are not meeting academically. NYSESLAT results show that many of our Developing ELLs struggle with listening and writing. To address these challenges, we implement targeted interventions and scaffolds that include: pre-teaching key vocabulary and concepts before listening tasks, use of visuals, gestures, and realia to support understanding, graphic organizers, chunking audio/text with comprehension checks, interactive read-alouds ,and repetition/paraphrasing of directions and key information. Specifically for writing we provide sentence frames and sentence starters, word banks and content-specific vocabulary lists, modeled writing/shared writing, targeted mini-lessons, peer editing with checklists, prompts, writing conferences and small-group instruction focused on writing specific needs.

**What percentage of students are former ELLs? How is your school providing mandated instruction to former ELLs?**

6.6% of students are former ELLs. In accordance with CR Part 154, we provide former ELLs with an additional two years of ENL services. Former ELLs receive 90 minutes per week of integrated ENL and/or small group instruction from their classroom teacher or ENL teacher.

**2. Examine all at-risk levels that might adversely affect ELLs at your school. What trends do you notice about the at-risk levels of ELLs at your school?**

The at-risk indicators impacting the greatest number of ELLs are: Newcomer ELLs with less than 3 years of ELL services (86.6%), ELLs in Temporary Housing (38.1%), and ELLs not demonstrating sufficient ELP progress (23.9-%)

When comparing the data to the one from the previous school year (2023-24 v. 2024-25), we can say that:
- The percentage of ELLs in Temporary Housing has increased about 8% from 30.4% in 2024 to 38.1% in 2025;
- The percentage of ELLs not demonstrating sufficient ELP progress has remained the same in 2025 as in 2024, at about 24%.

When it comes to “state test related” at-risk indicators, the percentage of ELLs scoring at level 1 or 2 in SY23-24 is about 20% (20.1% in ELA and 19.4% in MATH). The percentage of ELLs scoring level 1 or 2 in ELA increased about 2% from 17.8% in SY22-23 to 20.1% in SY23-24. The percentage of ELLs scoring level 1 or 2 in Math remained about the same as SY22-23 (18.5%) and SY23-24 (19.4%).

**3. Examine all at-risk levels that might adversely affect former ELLs at your school. What trends do you notice about the at-risk levels of former ELLs at your school?**

The at-risk indicator that most affects former ELLs is ELA and Math. The percentage of former ELLs scoring level 1 or 2 in ELA in SY23-24 is 35%, and in Math SY23-24 is 25%. This represents an increase from SY22-23, which was 26.7% level 1 or 2 in ELA and Math. This represents 4 students at level 1 or 2 in ELA and Math in SY22-23, compared to 7 students at level 1 or 2 in ELA and 5 students at level 1 or 2 in Math in SY23-24.

**4. What are the home languages of ELLs with the largest representation at your school? What staff, structures, and processes does your school have to support communication and learning that values these home languages?**

The home languages of ELLs at PS 8 are Spanish (98%) and Arabic (2%). In SY24-25, no other home languages exist among the ELL population. This represents a change from SY23-24, where ELLs' home languages also included Mongolian, Russian, and Soninke.

Most of our staff speak Spanish, the most common home language for P.S. 8 families. We also have staff members who speak Arabic, French, and Russian. These staff members are able to serve as translators as needed for family meetings. In addition, we utilize the services provided by the Office of Language Access for over-the-phone interpretation as needed for in-person and virtual meetings and school events/workshops. For written communication, documents are translated both by staff and the Office of Language Access as needed. All school memos are sent in families' identified home language. It is important to note that while the home languages of ELLs do not include French, Russian, or Soninke, those home languages are still present in our school community for former ELLs and non-ELLs.

**5. What are the racial and ethnic classifications of ELLs at your school? How are ELLs being included in planning and delivery of Culturally Responsive and Sustaining Education (CR-SE)?**

As per information provided by families during the enrollment process, 96% of our current ELL families identify themselves as Hispanic ELLs.

Within the Hispanic ELLs, the top 3 categories in the 2024-25 Ethnicity Breakdown are: 50.4% American Indian or Alaskan Native; 35.7% Hispanic Black; and 10.1% Hispanic White. This is similar to the top 3 in the ethnicity breakdown in SY 2023-24 with 48.1%, 34.1%, and 9.3% of American Indian, Hispanic Black, and Hispanic White respectively.

The ethnicity breakdown of the Non-Hispanic ELLs in SY 2024-25 are: 60% Non-Hispanic White, 20% American Indian or Alaskan Native, and 20% non-Hispanic Multiracial.

To plan and deliver Culturally Responsive and Sustaining Education (CR-SE), we provide students with a variety of multilingual and multicultural texts in their classroom libraries. Dual language classrooms also have full libraries in Spanish and English. Teachers include culturally relevant content in their instruction. Multicultural perspectives and celebrations are infused across content areas, and families are invited to attend classroom events and share their culture with the classes and school community.

**6. What trends do you notice in reviewing English Language Proficiency (ELP) growth at your school? How many students met ELP sufficient progress? How many students did not meet ELP sufficient progress?**

As per NYSESLAT 2023 and 2024 results, the percentage of ELLs exiting their ELL status (ELP method 1) has decreased slightly, from 22.2% in 2023 to 17.5% in 2024.

Similarly, the percentage of ELLs meeting annual growth targets (ELP method 2) decreased slightly from 25.4% in 2023 ro 17.5% in 2024.

Alternatively, the percentage of ELLs meeting Safe Harbor Cumulative Growth (ELP method 3) increased from 1.6% in 2023 to 8.8% in 2024.

Overall, the percentage of ELLs not meeting sufficient ELP progress by any method increased from 50.8% in 2023 to 56.1% in 2024. This represents over half of the ELL population not making sufficient progress.

**7. When you look at the results of the New York State English as a Second Language Achievement Test (NYSESLAT), what stands out? What trends are there for each modality?**

Proficiency Level Results
The percentage of students exiting their ELL status has decreased by 4.7%, from 22.2% in 2023 to 17.5% in 2024. Additionally, expanding level ELLs continues to be the group with the highest representation in our school, at 29.7%. Former ELLs are lowest represented at 10.2%, which decreased by 5.2% from 15.4% in 2023. The percentage of ELLs scoring at the entering and emerging level increased in 2024. 16.3% scored entering, compared to 12.1% in 2023, and 22.4% scored emerging compared to 17.6% in 2023.

Points to Next Proficiency Level
2024 NYSESLAT results indicate that 27.6% (8 of 29) of the expanding level ELLs were between 1 to 10 points away from scoring commanding while 51.7% (15) were less than 20 points away from scoring commanding and exiting their ELL status. These are the students that are closer to reaching English proficiency and exit their ELL status.

Additionally, 28.6% (6 of 21) of the ELL students who scored at the transitioning level were 10 or less points away from scoring expanding. 27.3% (6 of 22) of ELLs at the emerging level were 10 or less points away from the transitioning level. 31.2% (5 of 16) of ELLs at the entering level were 10 or less points away from the emerging level.

Modalities of Strength
Based on the 2024 NYSESLAT results, 24.5% of the ELLs in our school scored HIGH (90% or more questions correctly) in the speaking modality. This is 7.2 points higher than the percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH in listening (17.3%), but about five times the percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH in writing (5.1%) and more than double the percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH in reading (9.2%).

Writing continues to be the area where fewest ELLs can answer 90% or more of the questions accurately. Reading is the second lowest area of strength for our ELLs. In grades 2, 4, and 5, no ELLs scored 90% of reading questions correctly. In grades 2 and 4, no ELLs scored 90% or higher in writing.

Overall, based on “modalities of strength” data, grades 1 and 3 have the highest percentages of ELL students answering 90% or more of the questions correctly across modalities. Contrarily, grades 2 and 4 have the lowest percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH across modalities.

Modalities of Need
A significant number of ELLs are scoring LOW (15% or less questions accurately) in Writing. As per 2024 NYSESLAT results, 29.5% (29 of 98) ELLs in our school scored LOW in writing. This means that nearly one third of our ELLs are really struggling with writing.

Although speaking is the modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH, it is also the second modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring LOW. As per 2024 NYSESLAT results, 23.5% (23 of 98) of ELLs answered 15% or less questions in this modality correctly. Grade 3 had the largest numbers of ELLs scoring LOW in the speaking and writing modalities.

**8. What is the relationship between students' performance on the NYSESLAT and other state assessments such as the ELA assessment, the Math assessment, and the Regents exams?**

ELA
62.1% of all of the ELLs, including those who scored commanding on the 2024 NYSESLAT, scored a 1 in the 2024 ELA state test. This is about 7 percentage points lower than the percentage of ELLs who scored a 1 in the 2023 ELA state test (69%).

13% (2 of 15) of expanding and commanding level ELLs, scored proficient (level 3 and 4) in the 2024 ELA state test. This is similar to 2023, where 2 of 13 students (15.4%) scored proficient on the ELA exam.

Math

26.3% (10 of 38) of the ELL students who took the 2024 MATH state test, including those who scored commanding on the 2024 NYSESLAT, scored a 1 in this test. This is approximately 10 percentage points higher than the percentage of ELLs who scored a 1 in the 2023 MATH state test (36.1%, 13 of 36). Although more ELL students scored a 1 on the MATH state test, we still have more than a quarter of our ELL students scoring far below grade level.

More ELL students scored proficient (levels 3 or 4) in the 2024 MATH state test, going from 19.4% in 2023 to 28.9% 2024. This means that more ELLs across all proficiency levels, including those who scored commanding in the 2024 NYSESLAT, are performing on grade level in math, but the majority (71.1%) are still not performing on grade level.

**9. What are trends reflected in the NYSESLAT results of ELL subgroups such as ELLs with IEPs and SIFE? What do you think is impacting the results for these subgroups?**

IEP:
In SY 2023-24, 23.5% of ELLs had an IEP. This is about the same when compared to SY 2022-23 (24.2%); 21.7%, 34.7% and 30.4% of ELLs with IEP scored at the emerging, transitioning, and expanding proficiency level respectively in the 2024 NYSESLAT exam. No ELLs with IEPs scored at the commanding level in the 2024 NYSESLAT exam.

SIFE
2% of ELLs are SIFE. This is an increase of 1 percentage points when compared to SY 2022-23 (1%). This represents a change of one student (1 in SY22-23 to 2 in SY23-24). As per NYSESLAT 2024 results, 1 of the 2 SIFE ELLs scored at the entering level and 1 at the emerging level.

**10. (For grades 9-12 only) Please review your data in the Insight Tool and STARS to answer the following questions:**
**a. How many ELLs are on-track towards graduation?**

N/A

**b. How many ELLs in grades 11-12 have a documented postsecondary plan in STARS or ATS?**

N/A

**c. What targeted strategies and interventions are in place to support ELLs who are currently off-track to graduate in four years?**

N/A

**d. What specific strategies, engaging approaches, and interventions are implemented to support and retain students who are not on track to graduate within four years, ensuring they remain enrolled and are guided towards a successful graduation in the future?**

N/A

# Part V: ML/ELL Instruction

## Tier 1: Core Instruction

For additional information, refer to ML/ELL Instruction Professional Learning Module.

## Tier 1 Core Instruction

**1. How does your school provide ELLs with a high-quality academic experience that leads to deeper learning?**

Our school provides training for staff to ensure they are able to meet the needs of ELLs and provide culturally responsive instruction that leads to deeper learning. We prioritize professional learning for all teachers, not only ENL and bilingual licensed teachers, because all teachers work with English learners. Therefore, all teachers stay up-to-date on language instruction and culturally responsive practices.

ELLs in both dual language and ENL programs receive differentiated instruction based on their language proficiency levels and needs. Our literacy curriculum, EL, offers instruction that helps students build content knowledge while developing English language skills across all four modalities. Students engage in a high-quality academic experience that helps them build cross-curricular connections and solve real world problems. The core content instruction demonstrates and promotes the hallmarks of advanced literacies through engaging texts and rich discussions. During small group instruction, students are also provided opportunities for frequent writing with a focus on academic vocabulary and language development. Similarly, our mathematics curriculum, Illustrative Mathematics, provides students opportunities for hands-on learning, problem-solving, and linguistic development.

Our school uses a Multi-Tiered System of Support (MTSS) to ensure ELLs receive the academic and linguistic support they need to access high-quality instruction. In Tier 1, all ELLs benefit from embedded scaffolds such as visuals, sentence frames, and structured discussions. Tier 2 provides targeted small-group interventions for students needing additional support in areas like vocabulary, reading comprehension, and writing. Tier 3 offers more intensive, individualized support using data-driven strategies. Teachers regularly analyze student data during grade-level common planning time to identify needs, monitor progress, and adjust instruction.

**2. How does your school's leadership team ensure ELLs have access to core instruction/curriculum?**

The school's Instructional Leadership Team (ILT) considers MLs/ELLs in the instructional design at all times. The ENL coordinator and ENL out of classroom teacher are part of the school's ILT. We serve a high proportion of ELLs and always consider them when making decisions related to curricula, professional development, and supplemental materials. For example, to ensure equal allocation of literacy instruction in English and Spanish, the dual language

program will use Expeditionary Learning Reading curriculum. Since the Expeditionary Learning (EL) Curriculum is currently available only in English. As a result, it is essential that teachers provide additional support for our newly arrived students who are in the process of learning English. To ensure equitable access to the curriculum, teachers are expected to:
- Translate key materials and instructions where possible.
- Scaffold lessons to support language development.
- Use visual aids, gestures, and modeling to enhance understanding.
- Collaborate with ENL (English as a New Language) staff for strategies and resources

Teachers in the DL were also provided with a list of books that can be paired with the Modules and Units. This instructional design will provide a strong form of bilingual education to promote bilingualism and biliteracy. For ELLs in monolingual classes, literacy support is provided through linguistic summaries, appropriate scaffolding, ENL methodologies, and the use of supplemental resources.

Teachers have been allocated common prep periods to be able to meet with grade teams as needed to monitor student progress. In addition, our Teaching Matters coach works with teacher teams to ensure ELLs have access to the core curriculum. These meetings are structured to support the school's Multi-Tiered System of Support (MTSS) framework. During this time, teachers analyze student data, including formative assessments, NYSESLAT performance, and classroom observations, to monitor ELL progress across all content areas. The purpose of these meetings is to identify students' academic and language development needs, determine appropriate interventions, and plan next steps for Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3 supports. ENL teachers often join these meetings to provide guidance on language-specific scaffolds and instructional strategies. All staff work together to make sure ELLs get the support they need to succeed in core instruction through MTSS.

Similarly, we ensure the Dual Language classes have The Illustrative Math curriculum materials in both English and Spanish. The ILT and ENL team also ensures that scaffolds are in place to make curriculum accessible and support student success in all content areas, regardless of language proficiency.

The Instructional Leadership Team ensures that classroom libraries reflect a variety of cultures, languages, and dialects represented in our school community. We also have a committee that chooses a school-wide Book of the Month, which is carefully selected to provide culturally diverse representation and present cultures as an asset to learning.

The Cultural Committee, now in its second year, is responsible for organizing and planning positive workplace cultural activities and events. This committee will ensure that all cultures are represented and valued throughout our 2025-2026 school year and beyond.

**3. Describe how core content is delivered in each program model. Specify language, and the instructional approaches and methods to foster language development and meet the demands of the Next Generation Learning Standards.**

In our ENL program model, instruction for our ELLs is delivered using specific strategies (visuals, vocabulary development, graphic organizers, cognates, small group instruction etc.) that support the development of both languages in all content areas. Two out of classroom ENL teachers co-teach our monolingual classes with Common Branch teachers for a minimum of 180 minutes during literacy core content instruction to support the English Language Learners. Also, the two ENL teachers provide additional ENL stand-alone instruction for a minimum of 180 minutes to the entering and emerging students through a pull-out model of small group instruction.

In our Dual Language program, we use a 50/50 model of instruction in English and Spanish to support the development of both languages. Content areas will be taught alternatively in both languages. All classes have

resources and materials in English and Spanish to teach reading and writing during literacy. All DL classes deliver instruction using specific strategies (visuals, modeling, vocabulary development, graphic organizers, cognates, small group instruction etc.) that support the development of both languages.

**4. What instructional strategies and grade-level materials, including technology, do teachers of MLs/ELLs use to provide access to grade level academic content areas and accelerate English language development? Include core content area and language materials with consideration to specific ELL subgroups.**

**a. ELLs with IEPs**

Our ELL students receive an instructional program that incorporates second language methodologies and strategies to make content area, concepts and skills in Literacy, Math, Social Studies and Science accessible for MLS/ELLs. Highly qualified Special Education, Bilingual, and ENL teachers are selected to provide an interactive and structured curriculum that incorporates on-going assessments and differentiated instruction. These students are provided with Tier 1 and Tier 2 intervention through small group instruction and a push-in or pull-out model. All MLS/ELL and ELLs with IEPs have been provided with laptops computers where they have access to different digital platforms through the DOE TeachHub where they can access both ELA and Math content. The use of these student platforms and technology maximizes students' interest and gives them hands-on opportunities to interact with current trends. The teachers in all program models where ELLs are taught, including ELL-SWDs, use the following strategies: close reading, shared reading, guided reading, buddy reading, read-alouds, shared writing, interactive writing, guided writing, cooperative learning, flexible grouping, real-world problem
solving, visual aids/realia, explicit content area vocabulary instruction, facial expressions and gestures, accountable talk prompts, use of graphic organizers, technology (Internet, etc), cognates (associations), and hands-on learning activities. In addition, teachers include modeling and writing with support prompts and language frames for our ELLs and resources in student's home language. By implementing the strategies listed above, we are providing both access to academic content areas and accelerating English language development for our MLs/ELLs and ELLs with IEPs.

During literacy centers, all of our ELLs, including those with disabilities, get to strengthen their English language skills on Rosetta Stone (a digital language-learning platform). This provides these students with the opportunity to engage with the English language in multiple modalities through reading, writing, listening, and speaking. Additionally, we have an after-school tutoring program for our SWD ELLs in which students receive small group instruction and support in both literacy and math tailored to their individual needs.

ENL teachers collaborate with special educators and related service providers to plan for and align individualized language and literacy instruction as indicated in students' individualized IEPs. Together they ensure students are meeting their in IEP goals through informal and formal assessment data. They adjust supports based on student progress.

**b. SIFE**

To identify potential SIFE students we first administer the home language questionnaire and individual interviews of parent and student for signs of potential SIFE status. We also speak with the classroom teacher to obtain class formal and informal data. If their home language is one other than English and the student is determined to be a

potential SIFE  we administer the SIFE Oral Interview Questionnaire, the Multilingual Literacy SIFE Screener (MLS) and  the Writing Screener.

SIFE students have demonstrated needs in the identified areas: Students are developing literacy in their home language and are building their understanding of foundational concepts, content knowledge, and critical thinking skills These students receive guided math and supplemental math instruction in Spanish and available resources in their home language to improve basic conceptual and computational skills and practice word problem solving. In addition, in Literacy, these students engage in phonics in their home language (Aprendo Leyendo and/or Escalera if they are a Spanish-speaking SIFE student) as well as English phonics instruction using the Fundations program, guided reading, and shared writing groups through Tier 1 intervention. Picture dictionaries, flashcards, and culturally relevant materials are also used. Instruction is scaffolded for these students. An experienced bilingual/ENL teacher who understands the language challenges that these ELL students face addresses their specific needs.

### c. Newcomers

These students are predominantly in our Dual Language program and receive instruction in Literacy, Math, and all content areas from a highly qualified bilingual teacher. Tier 1 and 2 intervention is given to these students by the classroom teacher. In addition, highly qualified Bilingual, General Education, and ENL teachers will be selected to provide an interactive and structured curriculum that incorporates on-going assessments and differentiated instruction in our Title III Program. The Title III program will focus on vocabulary development, foundational skills, and syntax that will promote these students' English language development in all modalities.  Teachers ensure building background knowledge and target vocabulary with newcomer ELLs through multimodal supports, visuals, hands-on activities, technology, and the use of the native language.

All teachers engage in regular team-based data analysis during grade-level planning meetings, using both formative and summative assessments to track ELL progress. This includes reviewing NYSESLAT scores and  classroom assessments to identify student needs. Based on this data, teachers adjust instructional strategies, groupings, and interventions to ensure that all ELL subgroups, including Newcomers have access to grade-level content while continuing to develop their English language skills.

### d. Long Term ELLs

As an elementary school serving grades K-5, we will not have long-term ELLs with 7 or more years of service.

## 5. What supports does your school provide to ELLs with IEPs to achieve their IEP goals and attain English language proficiency within the least restrictive environment?

Teachers modify lessons based on the needs of their students as evidenced by the data collected. Modifications include the use of technology and  targeted specific phonics instruction (Fundations in grades K-3, SPIRE for grades 4-5). All classrooms will  incorporate a sound wall in addition to a word wall. Teachers of ELL-SWD students may provide these children with an entry point to the lessons by changing the way the materials and classroom tasks are presented. Teacher teams composed of ENL and Special Education Service providers meet and discuss individual student’s strengths and needs across content areas, to ensure appropriate scaffolds and interventions are in place for student’s progress. Furthermore, teachers, in conjunction with the administration, parents and related service providers, may elect to incorporate flexible programming into the student's IEP in order to give the child an opportunity to experience and succeed in the least restrictive environment. For example, an ELL-SWD student in a self-contained special education classroom may receive instruction in an ICT classroom or general education

classroom for a portion of the day. All lessons for all students are aligned to the Next Generation Learning Standards with modifications for individual students to ensure that each student's academic needs and IEP goals are met.

**6. How is home language assessed in each program model (DLBE, TBE, and ENL)?**

ELLs are evaluated throughout the year in their home language using the following assessments: Acadience Reading Spanish, iReady Reading Spanish, and end of unit Spanish assessments for Spanish modules along with teacher-made assessments. Students are paired in small groups and are given the opportunity to utilize their home language to complete class assignments and through student to student discourse. Students are encouraged to share their ideas in small and whole group formats. The students are able to read books in their home language by borrowing books from the classroom and/or school library. In addition, there are classroom genre-based libraries available to students in their home language at all grade levels.

For newly identified ELLs whose home language is Spanish, the Spanish Lab is also administered to assess their literacy skills in Spanish. This assessment helps to determine the student's level of literacy development in their home language. The results are used by teachers to inform instruction, plan targeted supports, and identify whether a student may require additional scaffolds in either language. This helps teachers align instruction with the student's strengths and areas of need in both Spanish and English.

In our Dual Language program we use a 50/50 model of instruction in English and Spanish to support the development of both languages. Units of studies in Math and ELA alternate languages. Science is taught in English, but teachers of Dual Language classrooms provide home language support using Spanish resources. Social Studies is taught in Spanish, but Passport to Social Studies is available in both English and Spanish. Linguistic summaries are provided to support students in both languages and bridge the academic vocabularies.

**7. (For grades 6-12 only) What language electives are offered to MLs/ELLs? How is your school preparing MLs/ELLs to obtain the New York State Seal of Biliteracy?**

N/A

**8. Describe systems and structures for supporting co-teaching and collaboration among teachers for all ELL program models available at your school (e.g. integrated co-teaching, Dual Language Bilingual Education teacher partnerships, etc.).**

ENL teachers co-teach and collaborate with monolingual classroom teachers, including Common Branch teachers and ICT and/or Self-Contained Special Education teachers. Some partnerships have common prep periods which may be utilized for planning and data analysis. Additionally, teacher teams may meet during Other Professional Work time and have had opportunities to collaborate in professional learning sessions after school. Dual Language teachers do not co-teach classes, but have opportunities to engage in vertical team planning and professional learning.

**9. Describe how your overall, annual professional learning plan ensures that all staff – including administrators, teachers and -non-pedagogical staff – incorporates learning specifically related to the**

**academic and social emotional needs of MLs/ELLs. Professional learning topics might include co-teaching strategies, or integrating language and content instruction.**

Our school uses a calendar to plan professional learning for all staff during allotted contractual professional learning time (Mondays 2:20 pm - 3: 20 pm). These professional development sessions are selected based on survey responses from staff and school-wide data. This allows us to meet the academic and social emotional needs of all students, 44% (134 out of 302 of whom are ELLs and even more are MLs. Therefore, almost all of our professional learning includes a focus on ML students.

Professional learning is facilitated both by in-school personnel, including our School Social Worker who provides professional learning opportunities for social emotional learning, and, outside, third-party vendors that specialize in MLs/ELLs. The social worker has attended training from Sanford Harmony SEL to help with students' social - emotional needs.

This year, PS 8 engaged in a series of intervisitation visits with three partner schools. These visits were designed to foster collaboration and professional growth across school communities. The central focus of our intervisitations was best practices for Tier 1 and Tier 2 ( small group instruction)—a key component of effective, differentiated teaching.

During these visits, PS8 had the opportunity to:
- Observe both Tier 1 and Tier 2 small group instruction in action across different grade levels and settings.
- Share strategies and tools that support targeted instruction and student engagement.
- Reflect on our own practices and identify areas for growth and innovation.
- Build relationships with fellow educators committed to continuous improvement.

These experiences have enriched our instructional practices and strengthened our commitment to meeting the diverse needs of our students.

Our 2025-2026 Professional Learning calendar will continue to focus on adapting and strengthening the strategies and best practices with the ELA curriculum, Expeditionary Learning, and the Math curriculum, Illustrative Math. These sessions are facilitated by our in house instructional coach, as well as external consultants(District-Wide Consultants). The sessions will be specifically tailored to address the needs of multilingual learners and ELLs, who are a significant part of our student population. Additionally, there will be special attention paid to the needs of dual language classrooms, as the new curricula offers very few Spanish resources.

**10. Describe your school's professional development plan in order to meet the mandated Continuing Teacher and Leader Education (CTLE) ELL specific hours for certification renewal as per CR Part 154 (15% of total hours for all certified faculty [holders of professional certificates in the classroom teaching service, educational leadership service and level III teaching assistant certificate holders] and 50% of total hours for bilingual education/ENL teachers receive ELL-specific professional development).**

Our professional development plan always prioritizes MLs/ELLs-specific professional learning because we recognize the need for our educators, who serve a student population with 40% MLs/ELLs. This year, our school will be participating in professional learning surrounding the new curriculum, Expeditionary Learning, Teaching Matters. As part of our efforts to ensure teachers are prepared to meet the needs of their multilingual students, Teaching Matters will engage teachers in evidence-based strategies to ensure that all students at all levels can produce clear, coherent, unified, and structured literacy. We feel this will meet the specific language needs of our MLs/ELLs students.

In addition, we will continue to enhance the instructional strategies, cultural competence, and differentiation techniques of all our teachers by continuing to participate in district professional learning sessions and partnering with outside organizations.

# Assessment

# SCREENERS

**11. Which screening assessments (e.g.iReady, MAP Growth, Acadience, or STAR Reading) does your school use to guide instructional planning for your ELLs?**

The screening assessments used to guide our instruction for our ELLs are Acadience and iReady for Reading and Math, the Beginning-of-Year Illustrative Math Assessment, and Fundations Intervention Placement screener in K-3. Based on the data collected from these screening assessments, teachers create small groups based on student needs to provide interventions. This data is also used to form ENL intervention groups, targeted towards English language and literacy skills.

**12. For all grades, list and describe your targeted intervention programs for ELLs in ELA, Math, and other core content areas (specify ELL subgroups targeted). Include the language(s) in which the intervention services are offered.**

Our ENL intervention/Title III for grades 2-5 program is offered Saturdays from 9:00-12:00 PM for 16 weeks. In this program, ELLs engage in classes focused on the four language modalities: speaking, listening, reading, and writing. The primary language of the program is English, although native language is used to support new students in the program.

ENL intervention is also offered during the instructional day to support MLs/ELLs students who are struggling to achieve academically across content areas. For example, ELL students reading far below grade level in grades 3-5, regardless of language proficiency level, are offered three to four periods a week of small group intervention with an ENL teacher using Fundations. In addition, the Literacy Coach and Special Education Teacher Support Services (SETTS) provide intervention in phonics instruction using SPIRE for low performing at risk students, including ELLs and SWDs. In addition to these interventions, extra academic support will be offered through tutoring, Tuesdays and Wednesdays 2:30 - 4:00 PM. Interventions are focused on improving English phonemic awareness, phonics/decoding, morphology, vocabulary, and comprehension.

We also use some digital programs to support our students' needs, for example, MYON Digital Library, EPIC, SORA, Starfall, and Fundations-Fun Hub. Our school Librarian, Ms. Parker has also been granted funds to build our inventory of books targeting our rich culturally diverse population.

**13. For all grades, describe how your school uses data to guide instruction for ELLs within a Multi-Tiered System of Supports (MTSS). Refer to the Instructional Leadership Tool for MLs and ELLs and MTSS Guide for MLs and ELLs to help in the development and implementation of your school's plan for MLs/ELLs.**

To form intervention groups, we use data from formative, summative, and screener assessments. The students who perform below grade level are grouped together for Response to Intervention. Students who did not show growth on the NYSESLAT were also selected for small group RTI instruction. RTI instruction is provided by our SETTS teacher, out of classroom ENL teachers, Instructional Coach, and classroom teachers implementing small group intervention.

Qualitative and quantitative data from unit, mid-unit assessments, and daily formative assessments are used to strengthen core instruction in literacy and math. Teachers closely monitor growth and identify areas of need to adjust their instruction.

# FORMATIVE

**14. Which formative assessments (e.g. NYC performance Tasks, ELL Periodic Assessment, HLA Assessment, DRA, teacher-created assessments, etc.) are used to inform and drive instruction?**

The formative assessments used at P.S. 8 are Fundations and Aprendo Leyendo Unit Assessments (k-3), Expeditionary Learning Reading Module and Unit assessments (K-5), Illustrative Math Unit assessments, and teacher-created assessments. These assessments are used to inform and drive instruction as teachers target the specific strengths and needs of their students. Teachers also provide small group intervention to students with similar needs within the classroom. All assessments provide teachers with information on mastery of content that has been taught, guiding teachers on when to reteach content.

**15. How do you ensure that MLs/ELLs are appropriately evaluated in their home languages throughout the year?**

ELLs are evaluated throughout the year in their home language using the following assessments: iReady Reading and Acadience Reading in Spanish, Fountas and Pinnell in Spanish at teachers' discretion, Aprendo Leyendo (for phonics reading skills in Spanish) and teacher-made assessments. Students are paired in small groups and are given the opportunity to utilize their home language to complete class assignments and through student-to-student discourse. Students are encouraged to share their ideas in small and whole group formats, which may be used as a form of assessment. The students are able to read books in their home language by borrowing books from the school library and also read digital texts in their home language.

During the ELL Identification Process, we interview all students whose home language is Spanish. ENL pedagogues conduct a student interview in both English and Spanish to assess language proficiency and acquisition needs. For newly arrived students, after assessing their English language proficiency with the NYSITELL assessment, we may also conduct a home language assessment. For newly identified ELLs whose home language is Spanish, we administer the Spanish LAB to assess their home language skills. Additionally, if we suspect SIFE for newly identified ELLs in grades 3-5, we will conduct the Multilingual Literacy Screener (MLS) and oral interview in the student's home language.

# SUMMATIVE

**16. Which summative assessments (e.g. NYSESLAT, ELA, Math, Regents, etc.) are used to evaluate the effectiveness of your ML/ELL programs and how does it inform instructional design and curricular decisions? (Refer to the ELL Data Analysis Tool).**

The summative assessments used to evaluate the effectiveness of our ML/ELL programs are the NYSESLAT, ELA and Math State Exams, and summative assessments from Expeditionary Learning Reading Program and Illustrative Math curricula. We use measurements of growth to determine which student subgroups need additional interventions and support.

**17. What is your NYSESLAT administration plan? How does your school ensure that all ELLs are tested with the NYSESLAT annually? Include the titles of the staff that will administer and score the assessment. Please describe your plan to ensure that all ELLs and former ELLs continue to receive mandated instruction during the testing period.**

The NYSESLAT is administered by our ENL/Bilingual Coordinator, out-of-classroom ENL Intervention Teacher, and classroom ENL and Bilingual Teachers. The ENL/Bilingual Coordinator, out-of-classroom ENL Intervention Teacher, Literacy Coach and classroom ENL and Bilingual Teachers will score the Writing modality of the NYSESLAT assessment. The testing administration and scoring schedule is based around the mandated ENL services. The ENL Intervention teacher and ENL/Bilingual Coordinator will use periods designated for ENL/Bilingual compliance to administer the speaking section and complete scoring to ensure continuity of services and the completion of the mandated testing. ENL teachers will also be providing content for classroom teachers to support ELLs and former ELLs during the testing period.

A memo is sent to all school staff outlining the schedule and procedures for NYSESLAT administration. Staff members who will be involved in the administration of the NYSESLAT also participate in NYSESLAT testing meetings to review testing protocols and accommodations. Parents are notified in advance of the NYSESLAT schedule and receive the NYSESLAT Parent Information Brochure in their home language.

**18. How does your school ensure that current and former ELLs receive necessary accommodations for state assessments, including the Specialized High School Admissions Test (SHSAT) if applicable?**

Our principal and assistant principal ensure that all students with disabilities, including current and former ELLs, receive their testing accommodations as stated on their IEPs. The staff who will be providing them are trained during NYSESLAT and state exam testing meetings with staff. Proctors are advised to become familiar with the accommodations specific to the particular test being administered.

Per New York State Education Department, we provide testing accommodations to ELLs, as needed, on all NYS ELA, Mathematics, and Science exams. All current and former ELLs are provided bilingual glossaries in their home language on all content state assessments. Additionally, current and former ELLs are grouped in a separate location with fewer students. Time extension, although an allowable accommodation, is not necessary as all assessments are untimed.

# Part VI: Family Partnership

## Family Partnership

**Required Meetings Under CR Part 154**

**Describe your schools' plan to ensure families of ELLs are provided with the required meetings** specified below as per CR Part 154. Include:

- Topics discussed during these meetings
- How your school ensures families receive necessary translation/interpretation supports to meaningfully engage in the meetings
- How your school schedules these meetings to facilitate attendance, and how your school maintains evidence of these meetings as required per the NYC DOE Policy and Reference Guide for MLs/ELLs.

**a. ELL Program Orientation to inform parents/guardians of newly identified ELLs of ELL program options, including the program goals and requirements for all three ML/ELL program models: Dual Language Bilingual Education, Transitional Bilingual Education and English as a New Language regardless of whether the school currently has either type of bilingual program and provide a high-quality orientation section on the Next Generation Learning Standards, assessments, and school expectations for English Language Learners.**

If a student is determined to be an ELL, the parent is invited to the parent orientation meeting by our ENL coordinator Joanna Matos. Parents receive entitlement letter with date of orientation and follow up phone call reminders are made by office staff to maximize attendance. The Parent orientation meeting provides parents with an explanation of each ELL program model offered in NYC; the parent video describing the three programs is presented (in parent's preferred language); Parents are also provide information on state standards (NGLS), curriculum, and are encouraged to ask questions so that they are informed about all ELL programs and services; translation and interpretation services are provided throughout the meeting through staff members and over-the-phone translation services from the Office of Language Access as needed.

The ELL Program Orientation happens prior to a an ELL student's final program placement and is offered in-person as morning and afternoon sessions to facilitate attendance. Additionally, we have offered virtual orientation for parents unable to attend in-person. We maintain evidence of the meeting through copies of sign-in sheets, agenda, presentation slides, and other additional resources. All copies are filed in the ENL Critical Documents Binder.

**b. Annual Individual Meeting to discuss goals of the program, language development progress, language proficiency assessment results, and language development needs in all content areas. Note:**

**this meeting is separate from and does not include the mandated ELL program orientation meeting and DOE-scheduled parent-teacher conferences.**

At the beginning of the school year, teachers are reminded of the Annual Individual Meetings required for families of ELLs, which are in addition to the regularly scheduled parent teacher conferences. All dual language and ENL teachers are responsible for scheduling at least one meeting to discuss students' academic progress, discuss goals of the dual language or ENL program, language development progress, language proficiency assessment results, and language development needs. Teachers use data from classroom assessments to inform these discussions, as well as state exams and NYSESLAT/NYSITELL data. Teachers reach out to parents using preferred contact methods (phone, email, or other communication platforms) to schedule the meeting. Translation is provided by staff and over-the-phone translation services as needed using The Office of Language Access to connect with families who prefer to communicate in a language other than English. A digital log of these meetings is maintained in each class's Google drive spreadsheet along with biographical information and data from throughout the year. Meetings are scheduled during teachers' parental engagement time, which is conducted remotely or in-person at teachers' and parents' discretion.

# Family Engagement

**2. Beyond the mandated meetings and orientations, describe how your school:**
**a. Ensures families receive all school communications and documents in the language they best understand. How are families able to respond or initiate communications in languages other than English?**

All families are provided with translation and interpretation services in their preferred language of communication as identified by Part III of the Home Language Identification Survey (HLIS) and ATS RCPL report.

Many of our staff members speak Spanish and we also have staff members who speak Arabic, French, and Russian. These staff members help with the translation of school documents. We also use translation services from The Office of Language Access (OLA). All our families receive the Language Access for NYCPS Families brochures that advises them of the availability of language services. Families also receive "I Speak Cards" to request language assistance when visiting our school. All posters informing families of translation services available are posted at entrance of the school and in our main office. We communicate with all our families in their identified home language, over-the-phone interpretation (OPI) is our main source of translation for parents who do not feel comfortable with the English language. In addition, our school website includes a translation function that enables users to translate all posted content into any language.

The school uses translation and interpretation funds to to ensure meaningful communication with families who have limited English proficiency for devices like headsets that support translation and interpretation, supplies related to producing translated materials, classroom materials that involve translation like bilingual dictionaries and for interpretation and translation services when not available through the office of Language Access.

Besides the communication among the ENL team and parents, the Parent Coordinator keeps parents informed of workshops and trainings for parents offered by District 06 or the DOE via email (PS 8 Parent Group), mass text sent to the entire school body or specific grades via DOE platform, PS8 school website, social media page, and flyers.

**b. Develops activities that foster empowerment for families of MLs/ELLs. Include how your school determines the needs of your community.**

As a school, we also engage in social media as a form of family communication. The P.S. 8 social media accounts are used to post announcements, connect families with what is happening in the classrooms and in the school through photos and videos, and can also be used as a platform for parents to reach out with questions or concerns. Families are not only encouraged to reach out, but also to share their own experiences and photos and tag our accounts. This empowers and strengthens the sense of community between the parents and the school.

At the entrance of the school there is a showcase display with information about events and announcements, and activities happening during the current school year.

Finally, families are invited to monthly meetings with the principal in which they can express any concerns, questions, or successes. Data collected from these meetings is used to inform the focus for future parent engagement activities. These meetings are held in English and Spanish, but interpretation services are available for speakers of other languages.

Parent engagement activities throughout the year include information sessions from community organizations such as NMIC, school community events such as our Multicultural Fair, and parent workshops from vendors like Elevate.

### c. Ensures families of MLs/ELLs are aware of family leadership opportunities (such as Parent Association (PA), School Leadership Team (SLT), Community Education Council (CEC), etc.)

Families are made aware of leadership opportunities by flyers and announcements sent home. All flyers are sent home in the preferred language of each family. Each year, all families receive information about Parent Association and School Leadership Team elections.

Our current PA president is a parent of an ELL. Parents of ELLs also serve on the SLT. About half of the parent representatives are parents of ELL students. Any parents who wish to volunteer in our school are directed to our PA president and Parent Coordinator.

### 3. What culturally and linguistically responsive partnerships do you currently have that support the needs of your school community?

As a community school, we have developed strong partnerships with different organizations to provide support to our MLs/ ELLs students and the diverse needs of our school community. We have developed strong partnerships with: Studio in a School, Caring at Columbia-Drama Program, Dancing Classrooms, Orchestrating Dreams, Drip Sweat Movement Program, Robotics, and Patty-Cake After-school program. In addition, we have developed partnerships with nonprofit organizations like NMIC that provide our families with free services in housing, education, immigration, and social services.

We are also a Children's Aid Community School. Children's Aid helps to also connect our families with community resources and provides enrichment programs, and health services.

# Part VII: Additional Information

## Additional Information

**Include any additional information that is relevant to your LAP and would further explain and highlight how your school supports MLs/ELLs. This form does not allow graphics and charts to be pasted.**

Our school leverages STEM instruction to support ELLs, particularly newcomers. Our STEM teacher is a certified ENL and bilingual (Spanish) teacher who incorporates a variety of strategies to create accessible content and language instruction for ELLs and Newcomers. Students engage in hands-on, inquiry-based projects in which they can learn through experience regardless of language barriers. Students are encouraged to use translanguaging and write to express themselves in their home language when needed to demonstrate content knowledge. To continue to build academic vocabulary, a bilingual word wall with visuals is displayed in the STEM lab. Additionally, students engage in a variety of coding projects, learning code as the language used to communicate with robots and computers. Different forms of block coding for elementary students all include color-coded visuals that support students of any linguistic background, and those still developing literacy skills. Through STEM all our ELLs are given meaningful opportunities to practice English in authentic, real-world contexts while building confidence and critical thinking skill.

# Part VIII: ELL Identification Attestation and Principal Certification

## Identification Plan

For additional information, refer to ELL Identification Attestation Professional Learning Module.

**1. What are the titles of the members of your ELL identification team? Note: Members of the ELL identification team must be pedagogues.**

At the beginning of the school year, an intake identification team is created. Our ENL/Bilingual Coordinator and ENL certified teacher form the team. This team works together with the school Pupil secretary and Family worker during the registration process to assist parents. Our Parent Coordinator also supports parents with the completion of paperwork during registration. A team of school personnel who can provide language translation in Arabic, French, Spanish and Russian provides language assistance during the registration process at the beginning and throughout the school year.

The team that completes the ELL identification process is our ENL department comprised of two teachers: Joanna Matos (Bilingual & ENL Coordinator) and Eleni Filippatos (ENL teacher). The office staff who complete intake and registration are Giselle Alba, family worker, and Gabriela Gomez, school secretary. Upon registration they notify us so we can conduct the Home Language Identification Survey and begin the ELL Identification Process.

**2. Describe the structures and process in place for identification of ELLs year-round as required by the NYC DOE Policy & Reference Guide for MLs/ELLs, including your school's identification plan for any incoming students with an Individualized Education Plan (IEP). Include:**

- **How your school proactively plans for the ELL identification process so that it does not interrupt the provision of mandated ENL and/or bilingual instruction to current, former and potential ELLs,**
- **Who is responsible for each step of the ELL identification process, and**
- **School's plan for ensuring ELLs and former ELLs will continue to receive mandated instruction.**

The first step of the ELL Identification process, which involves the Determination of Enrollment, is carried out by our office family worker, Giselle Alba, and the school secretary, Gabriela Gomez.

All subsequent steps of the ELL Identification process including the administration of the Home Language Survey, determination of NYSITELL eligibility, parent notification of entitlement, Spanish LAB administration, identification of SIFE students, parent orientation, and placement into an ELL program are completed by our ENL Coordinator/Teacher, Mrs. Joanna Matos, along with our ENL teacher, Ms. Eleni Filippatos. If a student is incoming with an individualized Education Plan (IEP) the ELL Identification Process is completed within twenty days of enrollment. If the IEP student is identified to have a HL code other that English and English language acquisition

needs based on the in depth student interview, than NYSITELL eligibility is  based on the determination of the Language Proficiency Team (LPT) which further assesses  NYSITELL eligibility and  makes a recommendation.

The ELL Identification Team creates a schedule at the beginning of the year with licensed pedagogue's availability to conduct the Home Language Identification Survey. This includes prep and compliance periods of the ENL team. This ensures that mandated ENL instruction is not interrupted by the identification process. The schedule is shared with the office staff who are part of the intake process and used to schedule appointments with prospective families.

# Principal Certification

In accordance with New York State's Commissioner's Regulations Part 154 as outlined and implemented in the NYC DOE Policy and Reference Guide for MLs/ELLs, I, attest that the following ELL identification procedures and activities are adhered to, and staff are trained on the items listed below.

- The ELL Identification Process is completed for each student within 10 school days of enrollment (20 school days for students entering with IEPs).
- Enrollment status of each newly admitted student is determined:
  a. If a student has been in New York State public schools within the past 2 years, our school contacts the previous school to obtain ELL status, relevant assessment scores, and English language proficiency level.
  b. If a student has been outside of New York State public schools for more than 2 years, our school administers the ELL Identification Process as part of reentry.

- The home language of the student is determined by a trained and licensed pedagogue.
  a. The parent completes the Home Language Identification Survey in the parent's preferred language; translation services are provided by a bilingual staff member, the DOE's over-the-phone translation services, or an alternative, high quality translation service.

- An interview with parents and students in English and the home language is conducted. This includes reviewing documents, prior assessments, and academic experience. An assessment of the student's abilities and/or work samples determines the student's literacy and math level in his/her home language.
- Eligibility for the NYSITELL is determined.
  a. If the newly enrolled student is entering with an IEP, the school's Language Proficiency Team (LPT) recommends eligibility to the principal, who obtains final approval from the superintendent.

- Students are administered the NYSITELL, if eligible.
- Notification letters are sent to the parent/guardian in their preferred language.
  a. Parent is notified of their child's ELL status and results of the NYSITELL.

- If the student is identified as an ELL and the student's home language is Spanish, the student is administered the Spanish Language Assessment Battery (LAB).
- Student with Interrupted/Inconsistent Formal Education (SIFE) status is determined using New York State's resources.
- If a student is a newly identified ELL, the parent is invited to the parent orientation meeting.
  a. The parent orientation meeting provides parents/guardians with an explanation of each ELL program model offered in NYC; the parent video describing the three programs is presented (in parent's preferred language); parents/guardians are encouraged to ask questions so that they are

informed about all ELL programs; translation and interpretation services are provided throughout the meeting.

- ELL is placed in the ELL program that the parent selected.
  a. If the bilingual program that the parent selected is not available, the parent is offered a transfer to a school with that bilingual program in accordance with NYC DOE transfer policies.
  b. If the ELL remains in the school, the ELL is placed in English as a New Language and our school keeps track of parent selection so that when minimum thresholds are met, we can open the ELL program of choice.

- Parents are notified that they have 45 days to appeal the ELL status of their child (ELL Re-identification Process).
- If the ELL Re-identification Process is implemented for any student, the principal reviews the decision of any student whose ELL status was changed because of the ELL Re-identification Process within 6 to 12 months.
- Copies of documentation regarding ELL identification, including letters and parent notifications are kept in the students' cumulative files.

**Principal Name:**

Washington Hernandez

# Part IX: LAP Assurances

## LAP Assurances Page

For additional information, refer to LAP Assurances Professional Learning Module.

Download a blank LAP assurances page.

# LTI Overview and Part A: Designation of a LAC

Chancellor's Regulation A-663 establishes procedures for ensuring that Limited-English-Proficient (LEP) parents of students enrolled in the New York City public schools are provide with a meaningful opportunity to participate in and have access to programs and services critical to their child's education. To this end, schools must review and complete the annual LTI Plan to address its language assistance needs consistent with the requirements of this regulation.

The LTI Plan requires information on the following:

- Name of person designated as the Language Access Coordinator (LAC).
- Identification and assessment of LEP parent population.
- Identification of Critical Communications and standing, in-person meetings throughout the school year that require language assistance services and how the school plans to respond to these needs.
- Plan to ensure staff awareness of language access requirements and available resources.
- Provision of notice to parents on the available language assistance services.

Methods for the school to solicit and implement feedback on its provision of language assistance services.

**Office of Language Access (OLA) Contact:**

- **Contact Information:**
  - **Cunneely Elena, ECunneely@schools.nyc.gov**
  - **Rivera Ricardo, RRivera60@schools.nyc.gov**
  - **Williams Robert. RWilliams32@schools.nyc.gov**

Please do not edit

Ricardo Rivera

**Designation of a LAC**
**Name of person designated and trained as the LAC.**
**At the start of each school year, each principal is required to designate at least one staff member to serve as the Language Access Coordinator (LAC), responsible for overseeing language assistance services within the school.**

**We have pre-populated the following information based on our records. Please confirm that the designated staff member(s) are your school's Galaxy-designated LAC(s) and provide the date(s) they attended the OLA Language Access Coordinator Training. Note that this training is in addition to the mandatory asynchronous NYCPS Language Access Training for School-based Staff on the WeLearnNYC learning platform. If any information is missing, please provide the requested details.**

As a reminder, LACs are internal staff designations and are not meant to serve as the primary point of contact for families regarding language access-related matters. The Parent Coordinator, or another designated staff member, should remain the main contact for families regarding all issues, including language access.

| First Name | Last Name | Title | Date attended OLA Language Access Coordinator Professional Learning Opportunity | Confirmed (Y/N) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Eleni | Filippatos | Teacher - Regular Grades | 10/30/2024 | Y |
| Joanna | Matos | Teacher - Regular Grades | 10/30/2024 | Y |

# Part B: Parents' Preferred Languages

## Parents' Preferred Languages

Language identification and assessment of parent population.

**1. Check the resources your school staff uses to identify parents' preferred languages:**

,Part III of the Home Language Identification Survey (HLIS),Surveys conducted by your school,New York City Schools Account (NYCSA) Student Profile

**If Other was selected, describe the resource here:**

**2. We have pre-populated the following information from the Parent's Preferred Language Report (RCPL) in ATS. For the last two columns, please indicate the number of school staff members who are comfortable using their language skills to communicate with parents and regularly assist other staff members and families with translation and/or interpretation. If none, enter "0".**

| Language (Description within RCPL) | Written Preferred Count | Written Preferred Percentage | Oral Preferred Count | Oral Preferred Percentage | No. of Staff to Help with Written Translation | No. of Staff to Help with Oral Interpretation |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ARABIC | 6 | 1.44% | 6 | 1.49% | 2 | 2 |
| FRENCH | 1 | 0.24% | 1 | 0.25% | 1 | 1 |
| ENGLISH | 118 | 28.23% | 110 | 27.36% | 35 | 35 |
| RUSSIAN | 4 | 0.96% | 4 | 1.00% | 1 | 1 |
| SPANISH | 289 | 69.14% | 281 | 69.90% | 10 | 20 |

# Part C: Parent Communications and Engagement

## Parent Communication and Engagement

Identification of written critical communications and in-person meetings throughout the school year that require language assistance services and how the school plans to respond to these needs.

**1. List the documents your school typically distributes each year that require translation, along with your plan for translating these documents.**

| Document Type (e.g. parent flyers, IEPs, etc.) | How do you plan to implement the translation process? Please include procedures and resources to ensure the timely delivery of translated documents to parents. |
|---|---|
| Documents and letters from DOE | All notices directly from the DOE are downloaded from the DOE InfoHub in parents' preferred languages. |
| School letters to parents | School letters to parents are translated by the school secretary in English and Spanish. If any other language is required for translation, OLA support is requested. |
| Event letters and flyers | For all event letters and flyers bilingual staff are utilized to translate documents. For languages that are not spoken by any staff members, we contact the Office of Language Access (OLA) to request translation of documents |
| IEPs | All IEPs of students whose parents prefer a language other than English are translated by OLA upon completion of the NYC Public Schools' IEP Translation Request Form. |
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**2. List the meetings, both in-person and virtual, that your school typically holds with parents throughout the school year, along with your plans for providing interpretation services at those meetings.**

| Meeting Type (e.g. parent workshops, PTCs) | How do you plan to offer interpretation services? Please outline the procedures and resources in place to ensure timely access to interpretation for parents. |
|---|---|
| Parent Teacher Conferences | In-house staff are used for interpretation services to the extent possible. This includes many Spanish-speaking staff, two Arabic-speaking staff, and Russian and French speaking staff. For languages that are not spoken by any staff members, we contact the Office of Language Access (OLA) for over-the-phone interpretation services or in-person interpretation services. We schedule interpreters in advance and confirm their availability. |
| Parent Workshops/Meetings | In-house staff are used for interpretation services to the extent possible. This includes many Spanish-speaking staff, two Arabic-speaking staff, and Russian and French speaking staff. For languages that are not spoken by any staff members, we contact the Office of Language Access (OLA) for over-the-phone interpretation services or in-person interpretation services. We schedule interpreters in advance and confirm their availability. We ensure that workshop facilitators provide multilingual materials and bilingual presenters when possible. |
| Moving Up/Award Ceremonies | In-house staff are used for interpretation services to the extent possible. This includes many Spanish-speaking staff, two Arabic-speaking staff, and Russian and French speaking staff. For languages that are not spoken by any staff members, we contact the Office of Language Access (OLA) for in-person interpretation services using the OLA In-person and Virtual Interpretation Request form. We schedule interpreters in advance and confirm their availability. |
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**3. Describe the resources and processes your school will use to communicate with parents who speak a language other than English during an emergency (e.g., lockdown, fire, student attendance, nurse/hospital visit, etc.), or when a parent needs to contact the school in an emergency, ensuring communication is in their preferred language.**

In the event of a school-wide emergency, messages are sent to parents in their preferred language using the MySchools messaging system. Designated staff members of the Building Response Team (BRT) contact families who are not registered with MySchools. Bilingual staff provide interpretation to the extent possible, when not possible we use over-the-phone interpretation from OLA.

Bilingual staff provide interpretation to the extent possible for student-specific emergencies. When not possible we use over-the-phone interpretation from OLA. Staff in the nurse's office/medical clinic are bilingual Spanish-speakers and can communicate with most families directly. When  not possible the nurse's office/medical clinic  also uses over-the-phone interpretation from OLA.

If a parent contacts the school with an emergency, we identify the student's name and the preferred language. If possible, bilingual staff will provide interpretation services. When not possible we use over-the-phone interpretation from OLA.

# Part D: Staff Awareness

## Staff Awareness

Plan to ensure staff awareness of language access requirements and available resources.

**1. Describe how your school will ensure that all staff members complete the required asynchronous NYCPS Language Access Training for School-based Staff on the WeLearnNYC learning platform, and are familiar with the Best Practices for When to Provide Translation of Critical Written Communications to Parents and Best Practices for When to Provide Interpretation for Critical Oral Communications with Parents. Additionally, explain how your Galaxy-designated LAC will disseminate future language access resources and updates to all staff members.**

To ensure all staff members are aware of language access requirements and available resources, our school will implement the following steps:

At the beginning of every school year, the Language Access Coordinators (LAC) holds a meeting for all staff members.
They provide an overview of Chancellor's Regulation A-663 as well as all services and resources offered by the Office of Language Access (OLA). Key documents like the Over the Phone Interpretation Desk Aid, Best Practices for When to Provide Translation of Critical Written Communication to Parents and Best Practices for When to Provide Interpretation for Critical Oral Communication with Parents will be discussed and shared with all staff.

The school principal will notify staff of the WeLearn training. He will monitor and track staff completion of the asynchronous NYCPS Language Access Training For School-based Staff on WeLearn NYC. Reminders will be sent via email and staff meetings, with deadlines aligned to NYCPS mandates. Training completion will be documented in a shared tracker, and follow-ups will be conducted for non-compliant staff.

All resources will also be shared through staff email blasts and will be posted in a staff shared Google Drive Folder "Language Access Resources". Throughout the year the LACs will send out emails to staff highlighting policy changes, resources like translation services, and reminders. As well as update the staff "Language Access Resources" folder in the Google Drive with any new information and resources.

# Part E: Parental Notification

## Parental Notification

Provision of notice to parents on the available language assistance services.

**1. Describe how your school will inform parents about available language assistance services in their preferred language. Include any of the following:**

- **Translated signage**
- **Brochures, flyers, or letters shared with parents**
- **Parent engagement events where language assistance services are highlighted (e.g., PTA meetings, international parents' night, etc.)**
- **Messaging applications**

- Language Access for NYC Public Schools Families brochure

Multilingual Welcome posters and other signage informing parents of their rights are displayed at the school's main entrance and main office in all languages provided by the OLA. Parent brochures (translated versions) are also distributed to families to inform them of their rights at the beginning of the school year and provided to new families who register throughout the school year.

Language services will be highlighted at parent teacher conferences, parent meetings/workshops and open school night. In addition, Language services will also be highlighted on our school social media page and website.

# Part F: Monitoring

## Monitoring

Methods for soliciting and implementing feedback on language assistance services.

**1. In addition to the feedback received from parents via OLA's Translation & Interpretation Feedback Survey, describe the methods your school will use to gather feedback from parents regarding the language assistance services they receive in their preferred language.**

To insure continuous improvement of our language assistance services, at the end of the school year, in addition to the Language Access Parent Survey we will send home to all limited-English proficient families a school survey to gather feedback on translation and interpretation services received throughout the school year. The Language Access Coordinators (LAC) will use the data from the survey to inform best practices for the following school year. We will also collect verbal feedback at parent teacher conferences and family workshops and train staff to proactively ask, "if the language assistance was helpful" after interpreted meetings.

**2. How has your school worked to improve its language assistance services? Share any feedback results and outline your plans for further improvements in the upcoming school year.**

Results have been positive overall. Parents are satisfied with the interpretation and translation services they have been provided with. However, we will continue to improve these services by incorporating any new languages to our school community next year. We will continue to ensure our staff are aware of the regulations and language resources so the services continue to be provided to all families with a preferred language other than English.

# Title III Outline

**Title III Supplemental Program for ELLs for SY 2025-26**

## REQUIREMENTS

Title III supplemental services for English Language Learners (ELLs) must include the following three components:

- **Direct instruction** activities must be used to support language development, English and home language instruction, high academic achievement in math, and/or high academic achievement in other core academic areas. The Title III supplemental instructional services must be based on student need. These supplemental services should complement core bilingual and ENL services required under CR Part 154. Direct supplemental services should be provided for before school, after school, and Saturday programs. Teachers providing the services must be bilingual education and/or English for Speakers of Other Languages (ESOL) certified teachers.
- High quality **professional development** that is "of sufficient intensity and duration to have a positive and lasting impact on the teachers' performance in classrooms." Professional development activities should be well-planned, ongoing events rather than one-day or short-term workshops and conferences.
- **Parent engagement and supports** must ensure that there are appropriate translation and interpretation services to meet community needs. These are in addition to mandated activities, such as parent orientation during ELL identification process or annual ELL parent meetings.

**Note:** The Title III ELL program planning ratio is as follows: 60% to direct instruction, 10% to professional development (if funded using Title III ELL funds), 10% to parent engagement (if funded using Title III ELL funds), and 20% to OTPS (if funded using Title III ELL funds).

For more information on Title III requirements, please see the School Allocation Memo or contact your ML/ELL Director or ELL Compliance and Performance Specialist. Any updates or revisions to this plan must be made through the iPlan portal.

# Part A: School Information

**This school is (select one):**

Conceptually consolidated (skip Part E of this document)

# Part B: Direct Instruction Supplemental Program Information

**The direct instruction component of the program will consist of (select all that apply):**

,After School

**Total number of ELLs to be served in this program:**

86

**Grades to be served in this program. Select all that apply.**

,2,3,4,5

**Total number of teachers in this program:**

6

**Number of certified bilingual education or ESOL teachers (include teachers that are dually certified with TESOL certification/bilingual extension & common branch/content area certification):**

5

**Number of content area teachers (i.e., teachers that have common branch/content area licenses only):**

1

## Title III ELL Summary

**Provide a summary of each program funded under Title III ELL for SY 25-26: For each program, describe:**

- **When the program takes place (i.e., after school, before school, Saturday academy)**

- **Activities ELLs will engage in and how these activities will enhance instructional opportunities for ELLs**
- **How ELLs will be grouped for instruction and specify the number of student groups. Include total number of student groups and total number of ELLs in each group, for each program**
- **How instruction will be delivered (e.g., team teaching, parallel teaching, etc.)**
- **How the program will be supervised and whether this will be funded by Title III ELL. Please note: If supervision will be funded using Title III ELL funds, you must include the supervisor's regular work day hours and the hours the supervisor will get paid per session.**

The Title III Supplemental After School Program will be offered to all ELL students in grades 2-5 for the school year 2025-2026. ELLs will engage in activities to develop language skills in the modalities of speaking, listening, reading, and writing. In addition to NYSESLAT preparation, students will engage in reader's theater, foundational skills games and activities, and writing lessons.

The ELLs are grouped by both grade level and proficiency levels as follows:
Group 1: Grades 2-3, Entering and Emerging ELLs
Group 2: Grades 2-3, Transitioning and Expanding ELLs
Group 3: Grades 4-5, Entering and Emerging ELLs
Group 4: Grades 4-5, Transitioning and Expanding ELLs
Group 5: Grades 2-5, SIFE/At-risk Intervention Group

Each group will have 12-15 students.

Instruction will be delivered by one certified ENL or bilingual teacher to each group. The teachers will be paid per session from Title III ELL funds.

# Rationale for Title III ELL Funded Programs

**Describe the rationale for each Title III ELL funded program. For each program, include:**

- **Qualitative and quantitative data analysis that support the need for program, and**
- **Data sources used to justify the need for the program**

An analysis of the 2025 NYS NYSESLAT, and the 2025 NYSITELL as well as, the results of the i-ready diagnostic and Acadience reading assessments administered throughout the school year, indicated that a more rigorous approach to achieving English language proficiency was needed in the four modalities of language acquisition, Listening, speaking, of reading and writing. To that end, we coordinated an instructional program grounded in the Citywide Instructional Expectations, Next Generation/Common Core Learning Standards, and the Bilingual Common Core Progressions, with the goal of improving reading comprehension, fluency, and vocabulary development as well as, oral expression for our ELL population in the early grades. Close attention will be paid to those strategies that would best support all of our English language learners (ELLs), in the acquisition of second language proficiency.

Writing is the modality with the greatest need. A significant number of ELLs are scoring LOW (15% or less questions accurately) in Writing. As per 2025 NYSESLAT results, 29.5% (29 of 98) ELLs in our school scored LOW in writing. This means that nearly one third of our ELLs are really struggling with writing. The instructional focus for our Title III program this year will be to strengthen English writing skills through vocabulary development and direct instruction focused on syntax and craft.

Although speaking is the modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH, it is also the second modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring LOW. As per 2025 NYSESLAT results, 23.5% (23 of 98) of ELLs answered 15% or less questions in this modality correctly. Grade 4 had the largest numbers of ELLs scoring LOW in the speaking and writing modalities. We will increase the focus on speaking to address this need in addition to the writing.

# Students and Grade Levels to be Served

**For each Title III ELL funded program, describe the students that will be served. Include:**

- **Total number of ELLs for each program,**
- **Grade levels for ELLs in program, and**
- **ELL Subgroups (e.g., Newcomer) and/or proficiency levels (e.g., Entering, Emerging, etc.).**

For the year 2025-2026, our Title III ELL funds will be utilized to implement an instructional, supplemental after school program for 86 ELL students in grades 2-5. The English Language Learners subgroups that will be served include ELL-SWDs, newcomers, and developing ELLs in all proficiency levels.

# Schedule and Duration

**For each Title III ELL funded program, include:**

- **Start and end dates/months,**
- **Total number of sessions,**
- **Days of the week the program will be offered, and**
- **Time and duration of sessions.**

In order to support our ELL students in the acquisition of English language proficiency, our Friday academy Title III Supplemental program will provide the following: Students will receive 32 hour of instruction 1 day a week (Friday), from 2:30 PM to 4:00PM for a total of 16 weeks (16 sessions) from December 2025 through May 2026.

# Language of Instruction

**For each Title III ELL funded program, include language of instruction and how home language support is provided.**

There will be six groups of students taught by six teachers who will address the four modalities of language acquisition speaking and Listening for 45 minutes and reading and writing for 45 minutes. Groups will be determined by grade level and language proficiency level. For most groups, the language of instruction will be English. However, for the group of students at the Entering and Emerging levels of English acquisition, instruction will be supported in the students Home Language, Spanish.

# Number and Types of Certified Teachers

**For each Title III ELL funded program, include number and type(s) of certified teachers (e.g., ESOL, bilingual, content area):**

Six teachers and one administrator will be hired for this program. All six teachers will be certified in ENL or Bilingual Education. Teachers will work collaboratively co-planning and sharing strategies and additional materials to support students on improving language comprehension and skills. Each teacher will be responsible for teaching the four modalities of language acquisition. Listening and speaking, will be taught Fridays for 45 minutes, reading and writing for 45 minutes. One supervisor will collaborate with the teachers and supervise students during arrival and dismissal to and from the program. Supervisor will also monitor and supervise the implementation of curriculum.

# Types of Materials

**For each Title III ELL funded program, include:**

- **Types of materials,**
- **Titles and publishers of main supplemental materials,**
- **Location where purchased materials will be stored, and**
- **Whether materials will be purchased using Title III ELL funds. Please note: If materials are purchased using Title III ELL funds, they cannot exceed 20% of the total allocation.**

The materials and curricula for this program will be aligned with that of the regular instructional school day. The instructional materials we will use during the program are Exploring English Grammar, NYSESLAT Samplers, Reader's Theater, and additional NYSESLAT test prep materials. These materials will be stored in the ENL coordinator's classroom. The Title III instructional program is specially designed for ELLs and provides instruction that addresses the four areas of language development in a thematic way, with a focus on oral language development, listening, and fluency as well as games targeting language skills.

We currently have many of the materials mentioned above; however, we will use Title III ELL funds to purchase any additional materials as needed. We will ensure that expenditures on materials do not exceed 20% of the total Title III allocation, in compliance with the funding guidelines.

# Implementation Plan and Maintaining Records

- **Describe your school's plan for implementation (e.g. when and how parents/guardians will be notified about the program(s)).**
- **Describe how your school will maintain records of your school's Title III ELL funded program, including evidence of parent notification in their preferred languages, student attendance records, evidence of teacher certifications for teachers supporting the program, record of parent engagement activities, records of professional development activities, purchase orders and invoices to date. For additional information, please refer to the Title III ELL FAQ.**

All parents will receive a written invitation for their child to participate in our Title III program. Invitations are sent out at least four weeks in advance. Responses are collected daily and outreach is conducted for parents who have not responded. Responses are logged in a tracking sheet by class lists to indicate which students will or will not attend. Parent responses are filed in the Title III Critical Documents binder.

Teachers will maintain digital records of attendance on a Google spreadsheet. Copies will be stored in the Title III Critical Documents binder along with rosters, schedules, parent notifications, Title III applications, teacher certifications, professional development agendas, invoices and purchase orders..

# Part C: Professional Development

## Professional Development Summary

**Provide a summary of your school's plan for professional development under your Title III ELL program. Please make sure to describe:**

- **Professional development to be provided,**
- **Activities that teachers will engage with by topic, and**
- **Whether the professional development provided will be funded by Title III ELL funds. Please note: If PD will be funded by Title III ELL funds, vendor cost is calculated as part of OTPS and must not exceed 20% of the total allocation; teacher per-session is calculated as part of PD and must not exceed 10% of the total allocation.**

P.S. 8M. will provide professional development to all teachers participating in the Title III After School program for the school year 2025-2026. The ENL Coordinator and ENL Intervention teacher will provide professional development to teachers teaching Title III. 10% of the Title III budget will be allocated to provide professional development to all participating staff in strategies to support ELL students.

An additional, 10% of the Title III budget will be allocated to provide professional development to all staff in strategies to support ELL students. The professional development will be provided by outside vendors on topics relevant to best teaching practices for English learners.

## Rationale for Professional Development

**Describe the rationale for the professional development to be provided. For each activity, include:**

- **Qualitative and quantitative data analysis (e.g., patterns and trends identified) that support the need for the professional development, and**
- **Data sources (e.g., school survey teacher responses, in-house teacher surveys, teacher observation data) used to justify the professional development.**

The Instructional Leadership Team (ILT) has gathered information and feedback from classroom teachers of ELLs to inform the areas of need for professional learning and support. The team noticed a need for increased reading comprehension, writing skills, and vocabulary development. To this end, our i-ready and Acadience Reading data shows that most of our ELL population in grades K-5 are reading below or far below grade level. We will provide high quality professional development with a focus on increasing literacy levels to drive instruction for all of our ELLs. In addition, teachers are receiving professional development in the implementation of programs that focus on phonics

instruction, reading comprehension, and vocabulary development. Such programs include Expeditionary Learning, Spire, Aprendo Leyendo, Escalera, Fundations, and Heggerty.

We will also continue to provide professional development related to culturally responsive teaching practices. Teachers were engaged and expressed a desire to continue exploring these topics further.

# Teachers to Receive Professional Development

**Include information on the teachers to receive professional development. Please specify how all teachers working in the Title III ELL program will receive ongoing professional development related to the Title III ELL program.**

Six (6) teachers and one (1) supervisor participating in the Friday academy Title III program will receive ongoing professional development throughout the duration of the program. These professional learning sessions will focus on research-based strategies to support English language development, including vocabulary development, data analysis, differentiation, and integration of language objectives into content instruction. Teachers will also engage in collaborative planning and examine effective scaffolding techniques to support all four language modalities: listening, speaking, reading, and writing.

Due to the large number of ELLs in our building, participation in professional development for Title III teachers will be extended to all classroom teachers and/or teachers of multilingual learners. These sessions are designed to ensure that all staff working with ELLs are equipped with tools to promote academic achievement and language development aligned with the goals of the Title III program.

# Schedule and Duration

**For each Title III ELL professional development activity, include:**

- **Start and end dates/months,**
- **Total number of sessions,**
- **Days of sessions, and**
- **Time and duration of sessions.**

Our Title III teachers will participate in four hours of professional development. Two hours of professional development will be offered in November 2025 at the beginning of the program. The reminder of the professional development time will be divided into 1 hour sessions  dedicated to teacher collaborative planning.

Professional development for all teachers will begin in November of 2025 and take place during designated professional learning time on Mondays from 2:20-3:20.

# Topics to be covered

**For each Title III ELL professional development activity, include topics to be covered.**

The following topic will be covered during the professional development sessions:

Session 1: NYSESLAT and ELA Data analysis for the school year 2025-2026

Session 2: Second Language Acquisition Stages and Effective strategies to support English Language Learners.

Session 3: Effective Vocabulary Instruction for English Language Learners.

# Name(s) and Title(s) of Provider(s)

**For each Title III ELL professional development activity, include name(s) and title(s) of provider(s).**

These training sessions will be provided by the school ENL Coordinator, Joanna Matos, and one ENL out of classroom teacher, Heilin Capellan. In addition, we will be contracting external vendors.

# Maintaining Records

**Describe your school's plan for maintaining documentation (e.g., agendas, attendance sheets) of all professional development provided as part of your Title III ELL plan; please specify which activities were funded by Title III ELL funds.**

We maintain all records of professional development in our Title III Critical Documents binder. Documentation includes meeting agendas, attendance, learning materials, and receipts.

# Part D: Family Engagement Activities

## Family Engagement Summary

**Provide a summary of your school's family engagement activities under your Title III ELL program. Describe the activities that families of ELLs will engage with by topic. Please make sure to include whether the activities will be funded by Title III ELL funds.**
**Please note: If family engagement activities will be funded by Title III ELL funds, vendor cost is calculated as part of OTPS and must not exceed 20% of the total allocation; teacher per-session is calculated as part of family engagement and must not exceed 10% of the total allocation.**

Our school is committed to fostering meaningful  family engagement to support the academic and linguistic success of our ELLs. Family Parental engagement activities will be provided to parents and families, including families of ELLs.

Parents will be involved in a series of workshops that will provide them with tools and resources to support their children and help them to succeed.  In addition, they will participate in workshops that will help them with housing, legal services, citizenship, and other social services.

## Rationale for Family Engagement Activities

**Describe the rationale for the family engagement activities to be provided: For each activity, include:**

- **Qualitative and quantitative data analysis (e.g., reasons for topics, time activities will be offered), and**
- **Data sources (e.g., parent survey responses, in-house parent surveys, PTA/PA request, etc.) used to justify the need for activities.**

Quantitative demographic data indicate 96% of PS 8 families are economically disadvantaged. 17% of our families are in temporary housing. These support the need for family workshops focused on social services to meet their specific needs. Qualitative data from parent interviews during the registration and ELL identification process also indicate many immigrant families are living in temporary housing and are experiencing hardships related to social services. As a school, we want to support the whole child and meet the needs of our diverse families that extend far beyond the academic school day.

## Schedule and Duration

**For each Title III ELL family engagement activity, include:**

- **Start and end dates/months,**
- **Total number of sessions,**
- **Days of sessions, and**
- **Time and duration of sessions.**

Elevate Education will provide three workshops for families. The sessions will be held throughout the school year. Each session is one hour and will be held in the mornings in the school cafeteria. Additionally, NMIC and other community organizations will provide workshops for families. The duration will be one hour each workshop. Workshops are typically hosted on Wednesday mornings following monthly Coffee and Tea with the Principal meetings.

# Topics to be Covered

**For each Title III ELL family engagement activity, include topics to be covered.**

Elevate Education will provide family workshops on the following topics:
Home Study Environment- parents will learn how to help their child establish a high-quality study environment that fosters productivity and limits distractions.
Bullying and Conflict - parents will learn how to differentiate conflict and bullying, create self advocacy, and address concerns within the school community.
Goal Setting and Motivation: parents will learn the fundamentals of academic, college and career goal setting to help stay focused and motivated throughout the school year.

# Name(s) and Title(s) of Provider(s)

**For each Title III ELL family engagement activity, include name and title of provider(s) (e.g., vendor, community-based organization, school staff name in charge of facilitating the parent engagement activities described in this section).**

Elevate Education - Family Workshops

# Family Notification of Activities and Translation and Interpretation Supports:

**Describe:**

- **How families will be notified of Title ELL family engagement activities (e.g., phone calls, emails),**
- **How notification of activities will be translated into parent/guardians' preferred language, and**
- **How interpretation supports will be provided at events.**

Families will be notified of Title III family engagement activities via both email and paper flyers sent home with students in their preferred languages we will use school staff or the Office of Language Access staff for translations. Additionally, the events will be advertised on our social media accounts and school website in multiple languages represented at our school. Interpretation services will be provided by school staff or by the Office of Language Access (OLA) at family engagement events.

# Maintaining Records

**Describe how your school will maintain documentation (e.g. agendas, attendance sheets) of family engagement activities and notifications to families.**

For all parental engagement activities, agendas and attendance sheets are filed in the Title III binder, along with copies of any resources distributed at the event.

# Part E: Budget

**FOR SCHOOLS NOT CONCEPTUALLY CONSOLIDATED ONLY.** Ensure that your Title III ELL budget matches your Title III ELL Plan as described in Parts B, C, and D.

**This school is (select one):**

Conceptually consolidated (skip Part E of this document)

**Allocation Amount ($):**

25,092

| Budget Category | Budgeted Amount | Explanation of expenditures in this category as it relates to the program narrative for this title. |
|---|---|---|
| Professional salaries (schools must account for fringe benefits):-Per session -Per diem | 22,092 | Friday Program for MLLs |
| Purchased services -High quality staff and curriculum development contracts. | 1,250 | Teacher PD for the Friday Program for MLLs |
| Supplies and materials -must be supplemental -additional curricula, instructional materials -must be clearly listed. | 1,500 | Materials for Friday Program for MLLs |
| Educational Software (Object Code 199) | N/A | N/A |
| Parent Involvement | 250 | Parent celebration for students in the Friday Program for MLLs |
| Other | N/A | N/A |
| TOTAL | 25,092 | N/A |

# Title III Immigrant Outline

## Title III Application for Immigrant Funding

### REQUIREMENTS

Title III, Part A - Immigrant Funds can be used for activities that provide enhanced instructional opportunities for immigrant students, which include:

- Identification and acquisition of curricular materials, educational software and technologies to be used in the program.
- Family literacy, parent outreach and training activities designed to assist parents in becoming active participants in the education of their children and understand their rights and the benefits of multilingualism.
- Support for personnel, including teacher aides, parent coordinators, and school counselors who have been specifically trained, or are being trained, to provide services to immigrant students and families.
- Provision of tutorials, mentoring, and academic or career counseling for immigrant students, as well as engagement in pre-college and work-based learning experiences.
- Basic instructional services directly attributable to the aforementioned school districts, including costs for additional classroom supplies, transportation costs, or other costs directly attributable to such services.
- Other instructional services that are designed to assist immigrant students to achieve in elementary schools and secondary schools in the United States, such as programs of introduction to the educational system and civics education.
- School activities, coordinated with community-based organizations, institutions of higher education, private sector entities, or other entities with expertise in working with immigrants, to assist families of immigrant students by offering comprehensive community services.

Funding follows similar guidelines for Title III funds established by the Office of Multilingual Learners (OML) and can only be used to provide **supplementary services** to immigrant students, who may or may not be English Language Learners (ELLs).

**Please note:** Immigrant students are not necessarily English Language Learners (ELLs), and ELLs may or may not be immigrants. For the purpose of this funding, immigrant students are defined as individuals who were not born in any U.S. state (this includes the District of Columbia and the Commonwealth of Puerto Rico); and have not been attending one or more schools in any one or more states for more than three full, academic years (the months need not be consecutive).

Priority areas for the use of Title III, Part A - Immigrant Funds are as follows:

- Extended day programming (e.g., before school, after school, Saturday program) to provide targeted, small-group instruction, credit recovery support, and postsecondary preparation.
- Implementing strong student supports to increase graduation rates.
- Community-based and school-based programming (e.g., before school, after school, Saturday program) to strengthen partnerships between immigrant families and schools.
- Developing new and/or enhancing existing programs for newcomers (meeting criteria defined above).
- Supplementing the opening or growth of Transitional Bilingual Education programs and/or Dual Language Bilingual Education programs serving immigrant students.
- Professional learning on meeting the needs of immigrant students, creating a welcoming and inclusive school environment, and effective instructional practices.

For more information on Title III requirements, refer to NYSED's guidance on allowable and unallowable expenditures for Title III. For specific allocation amounts per school, see the School Allocation Memo or contact your ML/ELL Director or ELL Compliance and Performance Specialist.

**DIRECTIONS**

Please complete the application below. Schools must use the funds to support their immigrant students by developing a plan that has each of the following components:

- Direct instruction, supplemental program for immigrant students,
- Professional development that bolsters the instructional practice of teachers of immigrant students, and
- Family engagement activities that support families of immigrant students.

Completed applications must be submitted in iPlan for review and approval. Please refer to the respective School Allocation Memo. Schools are not permitted to use funds until they submit a plan and receive notification of its approval.

# Part A: School Information

**This school is (select one):**

Conceptually consolidated (skip part E Budget below)

# Part B: Direct Instruction Supplemental Program Information

**The direct instruction component of the program will consist of (select all that apply):**

,After School

**Grades to be served in this program. Select all that apply.**

,K,1,2,3,5,4

**Total number of teachers in this program:**

1 Social Worker, 1 Guidance Counselor, 1 Teacher

**Provide a summary of each program funded under Title III immigrant for SY 25-26:**

For each program, describe:

- When the program takes place (i.e., after school, before school, Saturday academy).
- Activities the students will engage in and how these activities will enhance instructional opportunities for immigrant students (including ELLs).
- How students will be grouped for instruction and specify the number of student groups. Include total number of student groups and total number of ELLs in each group, for each program.
- How instruction will be delivered (e.g., team teaching, parallel teaching, etc.).
- How the program will be supervised and whether this is at cost to Title III Immigrant. **Please note:** If supervision will be funded using Title III Immigrant funds, you must include the supervisor's regular workday hours and the hours the supervisor will get paid per session.

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
Immigrant students in grades K-5 will be offered after school counseling alongside social and emotional learning activities on Thursday's in a one and a half hour session. Students will engage in group counseling sessions and activities that will focus on their social emotional skills and mental wellbeing. The counseling will also enhance their academics by improving focus, self-esteem, and addressing any traumas our immigrant students have experienced. These counseling sessions will create a safe space where they can share their unique experiences. Immigrant subgroups that will be served include, non-ELLs, ELLs, ELL-SWDs, and SIFE students. Students will be grouped by grade bands: grades k-1: 21 students of which all are ELLs; grades 2-3: 22 students of which all are ELLs; and grades 4-5: 17 students of which all are ELLs. There will be a total of three groups. The counseling will be provided

by a certified school Guidance Counselor with a bilingual extension, and SEL activities will be facilitated by a certified Social Worker in partnership with the Guidance Counselor.

Instruction will be delivered through a parallel teaching model. The Guidance Counselor and Social Worker will each lead a group simultaneously, then switch groups midway through the session to ensure that all students benefit from both social-emotional counseling and SEL skill-building activities. Both professionals are certified and fluent in Spanish, allowing for culturally and linguistically responsive instruction.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
To build upon the current Title III ELL plan, Title III Immigrant funds will also be used to provide additional academic language support for immigrant students in grades 4–5 during the 2025–2026 school year.

Students will engage in activities designed to develop English proficiency across the four language modalities: speaking, listening, reading, and writing. In addition to NYSESLAT preparation, students will participate in reader's theater, foundational literacy games, and structured writing lessons to improve fluency, vocabulary, and comprehension.

Students will be grouped by grade level and English proficiency level (Transitioning and Expanding). Instruction will be delivered by one teacher, who will provide small-group, targeted instruction to support language acquisition and academic growth.

The program will be supervised by the school Assistant Principal during his contractual work hours and per session hours.

# Rationale for Title III Immigrant Funded Programs

**Describe the rationale for each Title III Immigrant funded program:**

For each program, include:

- Qualitative and quantitative data analysis that support the need for program, and
- Data sources used to justify the need for the program

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
Qualitative data from student and parent interviews during the registration process indicate students and families have experienced trauma in their home countries and during migration and continue to experience hardships finding services and assimilating in New York City. Classroom teachers also gather qualitative anecdotal data to justify this area of need in our community, noting that ELL and immigrant students affected by trauma exhibit challenges with focus, participation, and peer interactions.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
An analysis of the 2025 NYS NYSESLAT, and the 2025 NYSITELL as well as, the results of the i-ready diagnostic and Acadience reading assessments administered throughout the school year, indicated that a more rigorous approach

to achieving English language proficiency was needed in the four modalities of language acquisition, Listening, speaking, of reading and writing. To that end, we coordinated an instructional program grounded in the Citywide Instructional Expectations, Next Generation/Common Core Learning Standards, and the Bilingual Common Core Progressions, with the goal of improving reading comprehension, fluency, and vocabulary development as well as, oral expression for our ELL population in the early grades. Close attention will be paid to those strategies that would best support all of our English language learners (ELLs), in the acquisition of second language proficiency.

Writing is the modality with the greatest need. A significant number of ELLs are scoring LOW (15% or less questions accurately) in Writing. As per 2025 NYSESLAT results, 29.5% (29 of 98) ELLs in our school scored LOW in writing. This means that nearly one third of our ELLs are really struggling with writing. The instructional focus for our Title III program this year will be to strengthen English writing skills through vocabulary development and direct instruction focused on syntax and craft.

Although speaking is the modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring HIGH, it is also the second modality with the largest percentage of ELLs scoring LOW. As per 2025 NYSESLAT results, 23.5% (23 of 98) of ELLs answered 15% or less questions in this modality correctly. Grade 4 had the largest numbers of ELLs scoring LOW in the speaking and writing modalities. We will increase the focus on speaking to address this need in addition to the writing.

# Students and Grade Levels to be Served

**For each Title III Immigrant funded program, describe the students that will be served:**

Include:

- Total number of students for each program,
- Grade levels for students in program, and
- If ELLs are also included in these programs, (e.g., Newcomer).

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
All 60 immigrant students in grades K-5 will be invited to participate in the counseling. A schedule will be created based on interest, all 60 students are ELLs. All of these immigrant students are also Newcomer ELL students, many of whom are at the entering and emerging English proficiency levels.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
For the year 2025-2026, our Title III Immigrant funds will also be utilized to implement an instructional, supplemental after school program for 12 ELL students in grades 4-5. The English Language Learners subgroups that will be served include ELL-SWDs, newcomers, and developing ELLs at the transitioning and expanding levels.

**Schedule and Duration**

For each Title III Immigrant funded program, include:

- Start and end dates/months,

- Total number of sessions,
- Days of the week the program will be offered, and
- Time and duration of sessions.

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
Immigrant students in grades K-5 will be offered after school counseling/SEL on Thursdays for one and a half hour, from 2:30-4:00. The program will begin January 8 and ends April 30. It will be structured into three 5-week cycles, organized by grade bands. There will be a total of 16 sessions.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
In order to support our immigrant students in the acquisition of English language proficiency, our Academic Language Enrichment Program will be on Fridays, from 2:30 PM to 4:00PM for a total of 13 weeks (13 sessions) from January 2026 through May 2026.

# Language of Instruction

**For each Title III Immigrant funded program, include language of instruction and how home language support is provided:**

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
Since English language development is not the focus of this program, services will be offered in Spanish, which is the home language of almost all of these immigrant students. For students whose home language is not Spanish, counseling will be offered in English with home language supports whenever possible.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
This program will serve one group of students taught by one teacher, focusing on the four modalities of language acquisition: speaking and listening (45 minutes) and reading and writing (45 minutes). The language of instruction will be English, with strategic home language support in Spanish to ensure comprehension, scaffold academic content, and promote English language development.
Participating students are at the Transitioning and Expanding levels of English proficiency.

**Number and Types of Certified Teachers**
**For each Title III Immigrant funded program, include number and type(s) of certified teachers.**

The Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program will be facilitated by our school Social Worker and Guidance Counselor with a bilingual extension.

The Academic Language Enrichment Program will be facilitated by 1 certified teacher.

**Types of Materials**

**For each Title III Immigrant funded program, include:**

- **Types of materials,**
- **Titles and publishers of main supplemental materials,**
- **Location where purchased materials will be stored, and**
- **Whether materials will be purchased using Title III Immigrant funds. Please note: If materials are purchased using Title III Immigrant funds, they cannot exceed 20% of the total allocation.**

Trauma-informed Group Counseling Program:
Counselors will use games and social emotional activities purchased for their department in combination with Harmony Academy's social and emotional learning curriculum. This will not be at the cost of Title III immigrant. These materials will be stored in the ENL coordinator's classroom.

Academic Language Enrichment Program:
The materials and curricula for this program will be aligned with that of the regular instructional school day. The instructional materials we will use during the program are Exploring English Grammar, NYSESLAT Samplers, Reader's Theater, and additional NYSESLAT test prep materials. These materials will be stored in the ENL coordinator's classroom. The Academic Language Enrichment program is specially designed for immigrant ELLs and provides instruction that addresses the four areas of language development in a thematic way, with a focus on oral language development, listening, and fluency as well as games targeting language skills.

We currently have many of the materials mentioned above; however, we will use Title III Immigrant funds to purchase any additional materials as needed. We will ensure that expenditures on materials do not exceed 20% of the total Title III Immigrant Fund allocation, in compliance with the funding guidelines.

# Implementation Plan and Maintaining Records

- **Describe your school's plan for implementation (e.g. when and how parents/guardians will be notified about the program(s)).**
- **Describe how your school will maintain records of your school's Title III Immigrant funded program, including evidence of parent notification in their preferred languages, student attendance records, teachers that support the program, record of parent engagement activities, records of professional development activities, purchase orders and invoices to date. For additional information, please refer to the Title III Immigrant FAQ.**

The Social worker and Guidance Counselor will take daily attendance and records will be maintained in Google Drive and copies will be filed in the Title III LEP & Immigrant Program Binder. The same will apply for the Academic Language Enrichment Program

To implement these programs, we will send invitations to families informing them about the available supplemental services and benefits. Families will return the form indicating whether or not they would like their child to participate. Social Worker, counselors, and teachers will apply to the posted positions and those accepted will be paid per

session for the instructional hours. Training and planning time will also be provided before the start of the program.

Staff:
Supervisor: Jeffrey Salas (Assistant Principal)
Social Worker: Ada Suriel
Guidance Counselor: Haydee Lopez
Teacher: David Alexander

# Part C: Professional Development

**Professional Development Summary**

**Provide a summary of your school's plan for professional development under your Title III Immigrant program. Please make sure to describe:**

- **Professional development to be provided,**
- **Activities that teachers will engage with by topic, and**
- **Whether the professional development provided will be funded by Title III Immigrant funds. Please note: If PD will be funded by Title III Immigrant funds, vendor cost is calculated as part of OTPS and must not exceed 20% of the total allocation; teacher per-session is calculated as part of PD and must not exceed 10% of the total allocation.**

Please make sure to describe:

- Professional development to be provided
- Activities that teachers will engage with by topic
- Whether the professional development provided will be at cost to Title III Immigrant funds

P.S. 8M. will provide professional development to all teachers participating in the Immigrant After School program for the school year 2025-2026. The Social worker and Guidance counselor will provide professional development to teachers teaching Immigrant students.  10% of the Title III budget will be allocated to provide professional development to all participating staff in strategies to support Immigrant students.

An additional, 10% of the Immigrant budget will be allocated to provide professional development to all staff in strategies to support Immigrant students. The professional development will be provided by outside vendors on topics relevant to best teaching practices for English learners.

**Rationale for Professional Development**

**Describe the rationale for the professional development to be provided. For each activity, include:**

- **Qualitative and quantitative data analysis (e.g., patterns and trends identified) that support the need for the professional development, and**

- **Data sources (e.g., school survey teacher responses, in-house teacher surveys, teacher observation data) used to justify the professional development.**

For each activity include:

- Qualitative and quantitative data analysis that support the need for the professional development
- Data sources used to justify the professional development

A staff-wide survey was administered regarding professional development needs for all teachers. Many teachers indicated interest in ENL/Language Strategies and scaffolds as well as the use of technology integration to address the unique needs of immigrant ELLs. During grade-level meetings, teachers have consistently expressed the need for additional support and resources to effectively address the challenges of working with immigrant students.

In collaborative teacher team planning meetings, teachers have expressed interest in supports for working with immigrant and ENL student populations. They have express the need of additional tools that scaffold learning, provide engaging content and allow for differentiation in the classroom. An analysis of the ELA State test data shows that our ELLs are consistently underperforming our non-ELLs. 41% of all PS 8 students are current ELLs and all teachers have ELL students in their classes. Many of these ELLs are also identified as immigrant students. Therefore, the need for professional development applies to all teachers, not only ENL and Bilingual teachers. These professional development workshops will help all teachers to effectively support the linguistic and academic development of our ELLS and immigrant students.

**Teachers to Receive Professional Development**

Include information on the teachers to receive professional development. Please specify how all teachers working in the Title III Immigrant program will receive ongoing professional development related to the Title III Immigrant program.

All teachers including those working in the Title III Immigrant program will receive ongoing professional development related to the program. They will learn about research-based strategies and approaches that will help our immigrant and ELL student population make academic and social progress.

We will also provide professional learning for all teachers during select Monday professional development blocks from 2:20-3:20.

**Schedule and Duration**

For each Title III Immigrant professional development activity, include:

- Start and end dates/months,
- Total number of sessions,
- Days of sessions, and
- Time and duration of sessions.

Title III Immigrant professional development will be provided on Mondays during one-hour sessions from 2:20 pm to 3:20 pm. Each provider will host one session, for a total of 3-4 sessions.

Professional Development Dates:
Brainpower wellness- January
OTIS TEQ- January- February

**Topics to be Covered**

For each Title III Immigrant professional development activity, include topics to be covered.

The following providers/topics will be offered:

Brainpower wellness-bringing positive changes to classroom environments with our research-based and time-tested programs for wellness, mindfulness, and social-emotional learning.
OTIS TEQ- Hands-on Language: Manipulatives for ELL/MLL Comprehension; Tools to Support ENL Family Involvement.

**Name(s) and Title(s) of Provider(s)**

For **each** Title III Immigrant professional development activity, include name(s) and title(s)of provider(s).

Professional development will be provided by Brainpower wellness, and OTIS TEQ.

**Maintaining Records**

**Describe your school's plan for maintaining of all professional development (e.g., agendas, attendance sheets) provided as part of your Title III Immigrant plan; please specify which activities were funded by Title III Immigrant funds.**

Including your school's plan for maintaining documentation of professional development provided using Title III Immigrant funds.

Documentation of all professional development provided using Title III Immigrant funds will be kept on a Google drive as well as in the Title III LEP and Immigrant Program Binder. These documents include attendance sheets, agendas, slides, and any PD materials provided.

# Part D: Family Engagement Activities

**Family Engagement Summary**

**Provide a summary of your school's family engagement activities under your Title III Immigrant program. Describe the activities that families of immigrant students (including ELLs) will engage with by topic. Please make sure to include whether the activities will be funded by Title III Immigrant funds. Please note: If family engagement activities will be at funded by Title III Immigrant funds, vendor cost is calculated as part of OTPS and must not exceed 20% of the total allocation; teacher per-session is calculated as part of family engagement and must not exceed 10% of the total allocation.**

Parental Involvement:
Parents will be involved in a series of workshops that will provide them with tools and resources to support their children and help them to succeed.

All families of immigrant students will also have access to Rosetta Stone program to improve their own English skills while being active participants in their child's language learning.

In addition, parents will participate in workshops that will help them with housing, legal services, citizenship, and other social services.

# Rationale for Family Engagement Activities

**Describe the rationale for the family engagement activities to be provided:**

For each activity, include:

- Qualitative and quantitative data analysis (e.g., reasons for topics, time activities will be offered), and
- Data sources (e.g., parent survey responses, in-house parent surveys, PTA/PA request) used to justify the need for activities.

Quantitative demographic data indicate over 95% of PS 8 families are economically disadvantaged. 13% of our families are in temporary housing. These support the need for family workshops focused on social services to meet their specific needs.

Qualitative data from parent interviews during the registration and ELL identification process also indicate many immigrant families are living in temporary housing and are experiencing hardships related to social services.

As a school, we want to support the whole child and meet the needs of our diverse families that extend far beyond the academic school day.

Many immigrant families have expressed interest in English classes and increasing their own language development. This led us to purchase Rosetta Stone licenses not only to support ELL students, but their families as well.

**Schedule and Duration**

For each Title III Immigrant family engagement activity, include:

- Start and end dates/months,
- Total number of sessions,
- Days of sessions, and
- Time and duration of sessions.

All family workshops will begin in January and end approximately in May. Workshops will be held once a month in the morning.  Each workshop will be approximately one hour. There will be about  6 to 8 workshops provided to families.

**Topics to be Covered**

For each Title III Immigrant family engagement activity, include topics to be covered.

Elevate Education  - Home Study Hacks workshop, Stress Management workshop, Growth Mindset & Motivation
H.O.P.E-  Wellness program for families.

# Name(s) and Title(s) of Provider(s)

For each Title III Immigrant family engagement activity, include name and title of provider(s) (e.g., vendor, community-based organization, school staff name in charge of facilitating the parent engagement activities described in this section).

Family Workshops:

Elevate Education
H.O.P.E

**Family Notification of Activities and Translation and Interpretation Supports**

Describe:

- How families will be notified of Title III Immigrant family engagement activities (e.g., phone calls, emails),
- How notification of activities will be translated into parent/guardians' preferred language, and
- How interpretation supports will be provided at events.

Families will be informed of Title III Immigrant Family Engagement activities through both email notifications and paper flyers distributed to students. These events will also be promoted via our social media platforms and school website. All communications will be provided in the family's preferred language, and interpretation services will be available for all workshops. The school utilizes interpretation and translation services offered by staff when available; otherwise, services will be requested through the Office of Language Access.

**Maintaining Records**

**Describe how your school will maintain documentation (e.g. agendas, attendance sheets) of family engagement activities and notifications to families.**

At each event, we will have a sign-in sheet for all families who attend. We will keep a copy of sign-in sheets, agendas, and any materials distributed and file in the Title III LEP/Immigrant binder. Documents will also be maintained in the Google Drive.

# Part E: Budget

**FOR SCHOOLS NOT CONCEPTUALLY CONSOLIDATED ONLY.** Ensure that your Title III Immigrant budget matches your Title III Immigrant plan as described in Parts B, C, and D above.

**This school is (select one):**

Conceptually consolidated (skip part E Budget below)

**Allocation Amount ($):**

| Budget Category | Budgeted Amount | Explanation of expenditures in this category as it relates to the program narrative for this title. |
|---|---|---|
| Professional salaries (schools must account for fringe benefits):-Per session -Per diem | | |
| Purchased services -High quality staff and curriculum development contracts. | | |
| Supplies and materials -must be supplemental -additional curricula, instructional materials -must be clearly listed. | | |
| Educational Software (Object Code 199) | | |
| Travel | | |
| Other | | |
| TOTAL | | |